Study conducted for:

LEAP
La Porte Economic Advancement Partnership

Study funded by:

NIPSCO



FINDINGS REPORT

SSI PHASE II:
PRELIMINARY DUE DILIGENCE

STRATEGIC SITES INVENTORY (SSI) PROGRAM

October 28, 2022

Site ID: 18091-010

LaPorte County, IN

Study conducted by:

LEOTTA
LOCATION + DESIGN

Findings Report

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Barr Industrial Property

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010

SSI QUALIFIED SITE

Size and Location

Site: 230.5 acres
Buildable Area: 184.3 acres
300 E. Boyd Blvd
La Porte, IN

Lat. 41.5795 Long. -86.6905

Site GPA

3.8

Current Ownership

Rhoda Farms
Harold Barr

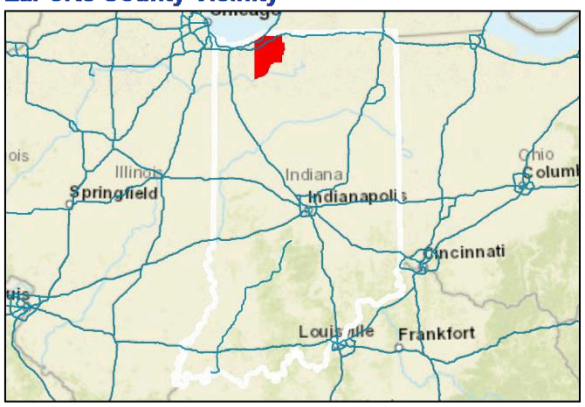
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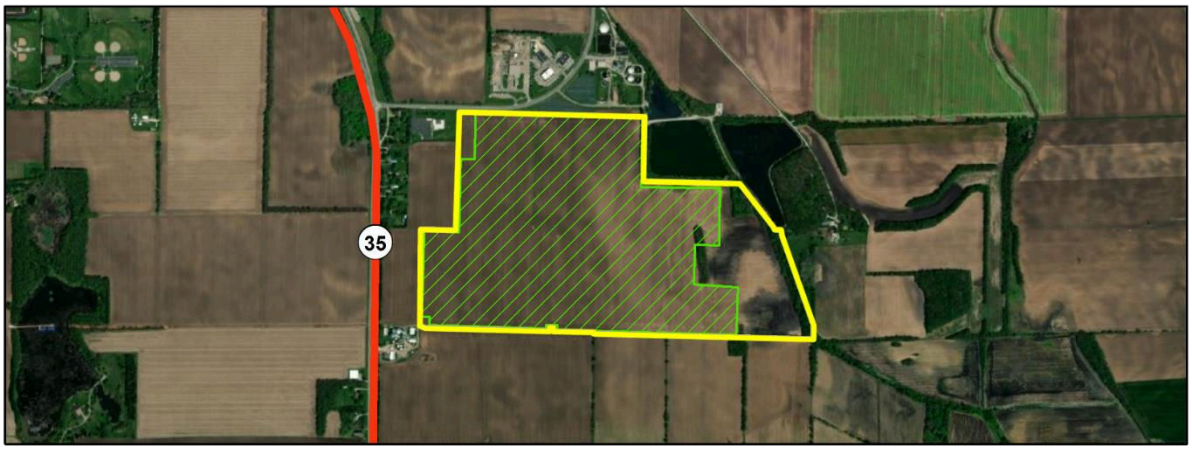
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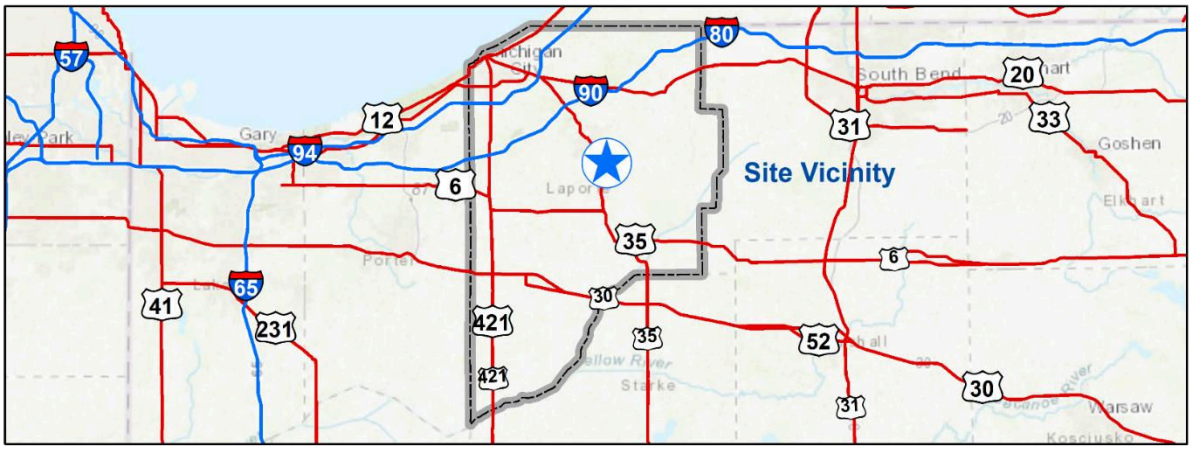
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Introduction

This report presents the findings of the Strategic Sites Inventory (SSI) Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence assessment of Site ID 18091-010 (referred to as the "Barr Industrial Property"), a 230.5-acre greenfield property in the City of La Porte, Indiana, which is located in LaPorte County and serves as the county seat. The Barr Industrial Property was nominated for advancement to SSI Phase II by LaPorte County officials and the Northern Indiana Public Service Company (NIPSCO). NIPSCO is the largest natural gas distribution company and one of the largest electric distribution companies in the state of Indiana, serving more than 821,000 natural gas customers and 468,000 electric customers across 30 counties. *The subject site satisfies baseline quality criteria, aligns with LaPorte County industry targets, and is deemed competitive to attract high-value business investments in support of sustainable community job growth and economic prosperity.* Report site maps are included as **Appendix A**.

SSI QUALIFIED SITE

The SSI Program is an advance site selection initiative designed to develop an inventory of strategic real estate assets to attract quality job-creating business investments. In 2019, the Indiana Economic Development Corporation (IEDC) initiated the Strategic Sites Inventory (SSI) Program in the State of Indiana with *SSI Phase I: Site Discovery* for all 92 counties with a goal to increase economic development competitiveness at the community level by identifying new, top quality raw land sites ideally suited for industrial and commercial projects. LaPorte County was included in the initial IEDC-funded project and benefitted from the identification of four potential high-value sites for mega site and heavy industrial land uses. A subsequent investment by IEDC in 2020 included expanded SSI Phase I site searches to identify light industrial and agribusiness sites, increasing LaPorte County's total of quality SSI-identified sites to forty-four. A total of 220 sites have been identified within NIPSCO's served territory.



Site ID 18091-010 was identified from the expanded 2020 IEDC-funded SSI Phase I project for light industrial and agribusiness land uses. The subject site exhibits necessary competitive characteristics for SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence nomination. Leotta Location and Design's SSI Phase II Candidate Site Index was designed to assist clients and communities with nominating the highest quality sites for advancement

to SSI Phase II. According to this indexing system, the subject site qualifies as one of LaPorte County's "top three" NIPSCO-served priority sites and ranks a top-tier priority site for light industrial land use within NIPSCO's statewide territory. The indexing process assigns an a-political score, or Composite Score, for SSI Phase I sites to provide a relative indication of site strength for advancement to Phase II. The subject site received a Composite Score of 94 out of 100. Details about the SSI Program phases are provided in **Appendix B**. The LaPorte County SSI Phase II Candidate Site Index overview is provided as **Appendix F**.

Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) has developed a systematic and effective methodology for screening potential sites for practical development as part of the SSI Phase II process. LL+D's site screening methodology is informed by fifteen-plus years of industrial and commercial site selection experience and economic development consulting in conjunction with demonstrated geospatial technology-based analysis and mapping expertise. LL+D staff and consulting partners include environmental science, civil and geotechnical engineering, landscape architecture, geospatial technologies, and economic devolvement experts who combine disciplines to identify and evaluate sites for industrial and commercial project uses.

The purpose of the SSI Phase II study is to provide a quantitative understanding of the subject site's advantages and challenges in conjunction with a rough order-of-magnitude (ROM) cost estimate to improve site functional use and mitigate development challenges. The SSI Phase II study is a desktop-based preliminary engineering and environmental due diligence exercise performed by discipline-specific experts with experience in industrial and commercial site selection and property development. Study of the subject site's physical and surrounding characteristics, assets, and impediments for development are reviewed in sufficient detail to formulate a defendable opinion on the competitive strength of the property for an economic development use.

The SSI Phase II study is intended to expose any potential "fatal flaws" that indicate significant development incumbrances or grossly compromise site competitiveness. The desktop review relies on an array of engineering, environmental, ecological, and cultural GIS data in conjunction with aerial imagery and available public records to assess current site development advantages and challenges. The SSI Phase II assessment concludes with the formulation of ROM cost estimates for improving site functional use and mitigating any potential development challenges.

LL+D's team of site selection and economic development experts provided an in-depth study of the subject site through an objective measure of physical features and surrounding characteristics and conditions across engineering, environmental, ecological, and cultural concerns. Overall site competitiveness for an economic development land use is made within the context of location requirements for permitting, construction, and operations relevant to the intended site project land use.

The SSI Phase II findings are expressed along three principal site assessment parameters:

Condition of the site's physical characteristics including assessment of engineering and environmental development advantages and challenges.

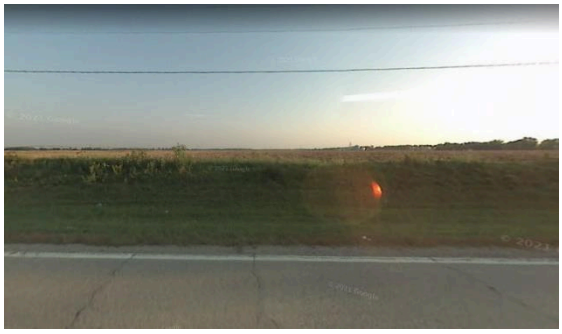
Connection to transportation assets, utility infrastructure, and major market areas.

Community support including available workforce, cultural feature impacts, and business climate for economic development.

A description of the subject site and summary of SSI Phase II findings is provided below.

Site Description

The Barr Industrial Property is an undeveloped (greenfield) property approximately 230.5 acres in total size located just east of U.S. Highway 35 (US-35) and along East Boyd Blvd within the City of La Porte, Indiana. The subject site is comprised of one tax parcel, or tract, independently owned by one landowner of record. **Appendix C** provides a summary of site parcel ownership information.

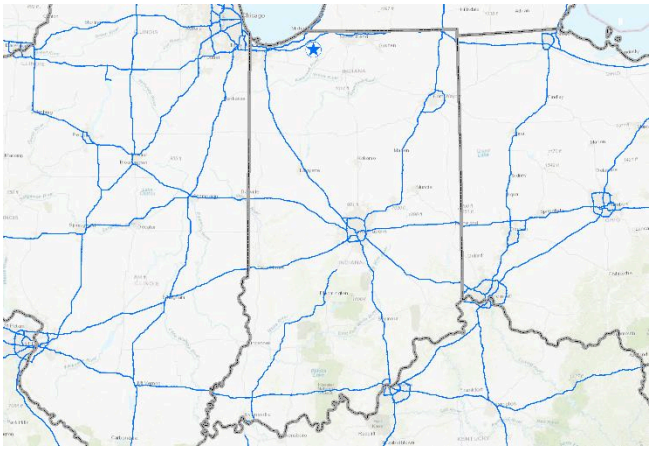


Site ID 18091-010 south view from East Boyd Blvd.

Current site condition is characterized by farmed agricultural land for the entirety of the site. The property has historically been used for farming. There are no structures currently observed onsite. No significant commercial or residential activity is observed on or near the site. Land use surrounding the site is primarily agricultural with residential and recreational land use within a mile. There are also various municipal facilities located just north of the site. Directly north and northeast of the site are the Indiana Department of Transportation: LaPorte District and the LaPorte Wastewater Treatment Plant. Located along the site's western boundary is a church and light residential activity. A middle school is located across US-35 approximately 1.07 miles from the site's westernmost boundary. The cultural setting is urban to the north and northeast and rural in all other directions. The site is bordered by East Boyd Blvd to the north. A pipeline easement runs along the site's southern boundary. *A contiguous "buildable area" was defined within the confines of the subject site boundary intended to be most advantageous for construction. The Barr Industrial Property buildable area is approximately 184.3 acres and encompasses the majority of total site acreage. A small area with lower elevation and associated hydric soils near the eastern site boundary was left out of the potential buildable area. A 200-foot buffer was also applied to the residential properties and church on the western/northwestern site boundary.*

Geographic Location

Located in northwest Indiana, LaPorte County provides a rural setting near several urban areas among the high-commercial activity Indiana Toll Road (I-80/90) and Interstate 94 (I-94), with access to major markets throughout the state as well as proximity to Chicago, IL. *In direct linear measure, the site is situated approximately 20 miles southwest of South Bend, IN; 44 miles east of Chicago, IL; 82 miles northwest of Fort Wayne, IN; and 115 miles northwest of Indianapolis, IN.* Projects considering the Barr Industrial Property will benefit from locating on the outskirts of an urban community that is strongly embedded in economic growth and prosperity amongst a primary network of connectivity, while avoiding the heavy traffic congestion and higher land costs typical of more highly populated metropolitan areas. Access to surrounding labor markets at competitive wage rates is well within reach of the subject site.



Site ID 18091-010 Site Vicinity

The subject site has been annexed into the municipal boundary of the City of La Porte, which has a 2021 estimated population of 22,383. La Porte serves as the county seat for LaPorte County, which has a 2021 estimated population of 112,390. The county is part of the Northwest Indiana and Michiana regions of the Chicago metropolitan area. *More than 626,245 total residential population live within a 45-minute drive of the site. Approximately 46,056 businesses employing 632,182 people are located within a 60-minute travel time*. Construction, manufacturing, and professional, scientific, & technical services account for 19.4% of businesses employing 29.3% of total workforce within a 60-minute drive time of the site. A site vicinity map is provided in **Appendix A**.



Site ID 18091-010 Aerial View

Current Ownership

The subject site is comprised of a single contiguous tax parcel, or tract, and is reported by LaPorte County officials to have a single owner. *According to county-provided information, the current owner of record is Rhoda Farms—Harold Barr. The subject site is comprised of a single tract of approximately 230.48 acres according to Esri GIS data, while property records from the county's public geospatial portal indicates that*

the parcel is 215.36 acres. LaPorte County economic development officials have confirmed that the landowner is actively promoting the site for sale. As of the date of this report, no known real estate purchase option agreement is held with any person or organization with the landowner for any portion of the site. *LL+D strongly recommends that LaPorte County pursue and secure a real estate purchase option agreement with the landowner. This is critically important to reduce uncertainty regarding property availability and price*. A "Site Parcel Configuration" map is included in **Appendix A**.

Findings Summary

The findings from the SSI Phase II study are summarized below. A discussion of key site development considerations is provided within the context of overall site physical **condition**, **connection** to infrastructure, and **community** support. LL+D's site competitiveness assessment across these key site development parameters are presented below.

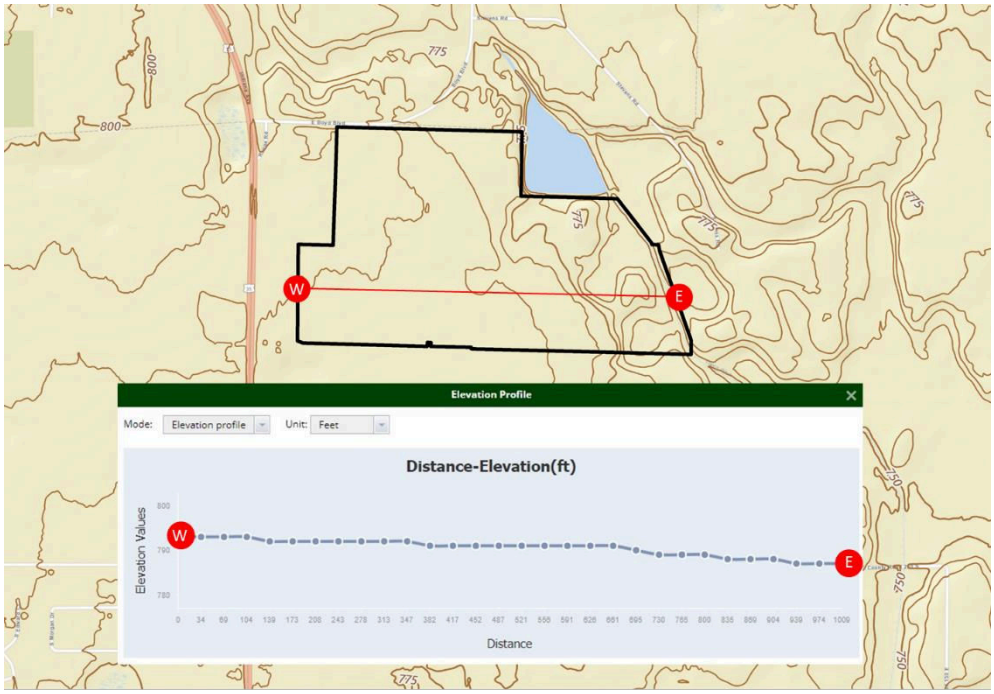
Condition

Site conditions are defined as the physical characteristics of the subject property including geometric configuration, surface features, engineering, ecological and environmental concerns, and land use compatibility. *Overall, conditions for the Barr Industrial Property are favorable for development for the site's highest and best use as an economic development real estate asset*.

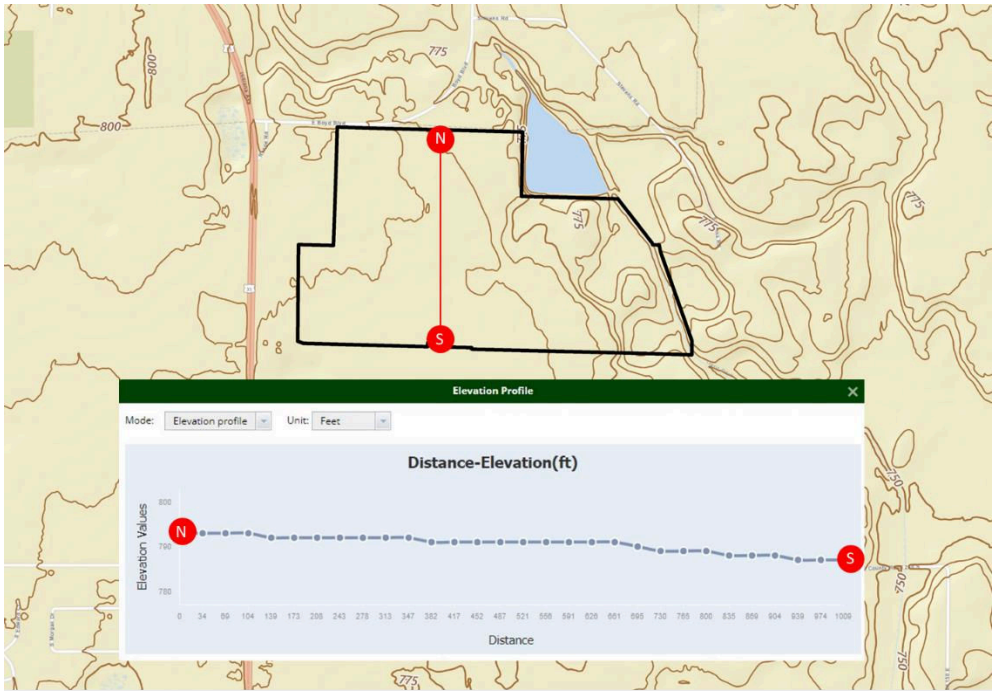
Size and Configuration of the subject site is sufficient in both acreage and configuration to support a Light Industrial or Manufacturing operation. *Total site area is approximately 230.5 acres, measuring approximately 4,851 feet across an east-west axis at its widest point and approximately 2,608 feet across a north-south axis*. The site is geometrically regular in configuration with adequate land between site boundaries providing ample acreage for a contiguous buildable area. The northern site boundary is bordered by East Boyd Blvd, the site's primary access road. U.S. Highway 35 (US-35) runs parallel to the site's eastern boundary and provides the site with an adequate route for truck traffic.

A contiguous buildable area totaling 184.3 acres has been defined to optimize facility construction on the site by positioning an operational footprint to avoid wet areas and a church/residential buffer zone. The buildable area occupies the majority of the site and is comprised of a single tract. Site access is supported by a single potential ingress/egress point located on East Boyd Blvd along the site's northern boundary.

Elevation/Topography presents minor grading challenges to prepare the site for development. *Based on a review of 5-meter cell size, LiDAR-derived digital elevation models (DEM) for the full site extent, a minimum elevation of 758 feet mean sea level (MSL) and maximum elevation of 795 feet MSL is reported. The 2016-2018 DEM indicate an average buildable area elevation of 779 feet MSL and average slope of 1.7 percent*.



18091-010 Elevation Profile West-East (USGS 3DEP Viewer)



18091-010 Elevation Profile North-South (USGS 3DEP Viewer)

The majority of the site is generally flat and without significant sloping. The lowest elevation occurs along the easternmost portion of the site, just outside of the buildable area. With the flat topography, there are not likely many cut-fill opportunities for use of onsite fill for grading/leveling. This analysis is subject to an onsite geotechnical engineering investigation to determine suitability of soil properties for construction. Additionally, any areas of naturally occurring sloping topography may provide passive locations for site buildable area drainage and stormwater retention. A LiDAR-derived DEM and 10-ft contour map is provided as **Appendix A**.

Land Cover assessment is useful for identifying site design constraints and/or potential encumbrances that may be encountered during site development such as extensive clearing and grubbing, drainage concerns, etc. The vegetative cover type is used in conjunction with soil types, elevation, and hydrography data for interpretation of environmentally sensitive conditions such as wetlands and potential habitat for Threatened and Endangered (T&E) species and other species of concern (discussed later in this report). Certain land cover features may reveal commercial value of forested areas or be desirable to incorporate into the site design. Features such as densely wooded areas may provide a desirable buffer during construction and/or during facility operations for line of sight and noise control. Another example is integrating wetland areas into site plans, thus providing an element of design aesthetics.

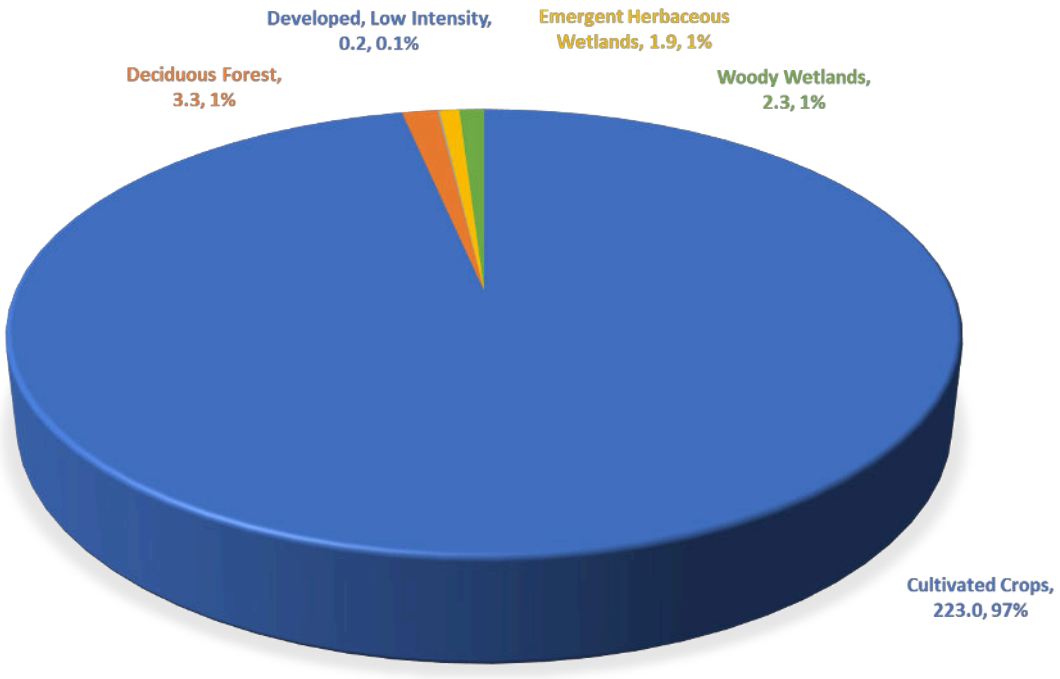
Two primary sources were used to assess land cover characteristics:

1) *Recent high-resolution color aerial imagery* (ESRI/Google Earth 2022). Recent and past aerial imagery provide useful observational data for assessing current land cover conditions, as well as any notable changes over time. However, aerial imagery alone cannot be used without additional data sources to provide a more specific delineation of land cover type. For example, densely wooded areas are readily observed from aerial imagery, however, determination of forest composition is largely indeterminate without other remotely sensed inputs (i.e., color infrared imagery) or ground-based observation.

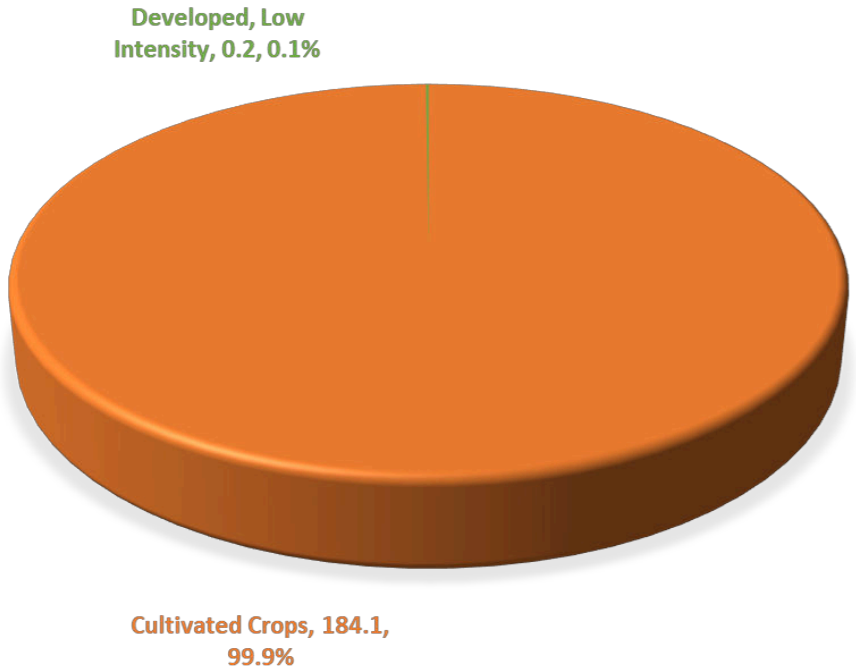
2) *The Multi-Resolution Land Characteristics Consortium (MRLC), National Land Cover Database (NLCD)*. The National Land Cover Database (NLCD) provides nationwide data on land cover and land cover change at a 30m resolution with a 16-class legend based on a modified Anderson Level II classification system. NLCD 2019 represents the latest evolution of NLCD land cover products focused on providing innovative land cover and land cover change data for the Nation. NLCD 2019 offers 8 integrated epochs of land cover for years 2001, 2004, 2006, 2008, 2011, 2013, 2016, and 2019. Developed classes in these years are directly derived from percent developed impervious surface and include a descriptor label that identifies the type of each impervious surface pixel. The NLCD Land Cover change index combines information from all years of land cover change and provides a simple and comprehensive way to visualize change from all 8 dates of land cover in a single layer.

Based on a review of the MRLC NLCD dataset, land cover for the site and buildable area consists of the following classified areas (acres, percent cover):

Land Cover – Site (acres, %)



Land Cover – Buildable Area (acres, %)



A Land cover map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Hydrography and Flood Risk were evaluated by consulting USGS National Hydrography Dataset (NHD), a geospatial database which identifies stream segments or reaches that make up the nation's surface water drainage system, and FEMA National Flood Hazard Layer (NFHL), a geospatial database that contains current effective flood hazard data. *Based on a review of NHD and NFHL data, the site and buildable area are highly favorable for site development with low flood risk and minimal recorded/observed significant hydrography features. 100% of the site is outside the FEMA-designated flood hazard area and is designated as Flood Zone X (within 0.2-percent-annual-chance flood or 500-year floodplain). A drainage ditch and pond are found along the site's eastern boundary. These features are located outside of the buildable area and should not pose any significant challenges for future project construction. This may be able to provide passive locations for site buildable area drainage and stormwater retention.* A hydrography and FEMA flood hazard map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Potential Wetlands are interpolated through observation of multiple data inputs including:

1) USGS National Wetlands Inventory (NWI) – developed for non-404 jurisdictional wetland mapping, so must be understood to have limited accuracy
2) LiDAR-derived digital elevation model (DEM) – topography/elevation
3) USGS NHD – hydrography
4) NRCS SSURGO – soils data provides hydric rating
5) Color-infrared imagery (where available) – for visual indication of wet or inundated areas (consulting differing years to ensure wet areas are not the result of a period flood event)

The NWI data is consulted as the principal indicator of potential wetlands, as the mapping methodology utilizes the above-referenced inputs in addition to other data sources in conjunction with qualified scientific review and quality control of interpolated wetlands delineation and taxonomy. The NWI data also provides a delineation of wetland types, which is important in the estimation of permitting burden and potential compensatory mitigation costs. The additional data sources are consulted to ensure congruency of information suggestive of potential wetlands occurrence.

From the US EPA Wetland Regulatory Authority fact sheet, wetlands subject to Clean Water Act Section 404 are defined as "areas that are inundated or saturated by surface or ground water at a frequency and duration sufficient to support, and that under normal circumstances do support, a prevalence of vegetation typically adapted for life in saturated soil conditions. Wetlands generally include swamps, marshes, bogs, and similar areas." There are three primary conditions required for surface areas to be considered wetlands: 1) at least periodically, the land supports predominantly hydrophytes, 2) the substrate is predominantly undrained hydric soil, and 3) the substrate is saturated with water or covered by shallow water at some time during the growing season of each year. As determined by the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers, the federal agency responsible for enforcing federal laws protecting wetlands, an area must exhibit all three of the above-referenced conditions to be considered a wetland.

The following GIS-based information was consulted for the desktop wetlands assessment:

- **Hydrophytic Vegetation**: Recent and historical aerial imagery and NWI data.

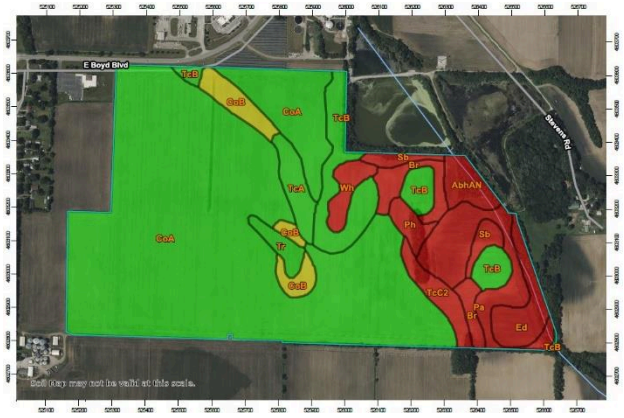
- **Wetland Hydrology**: LiDAR-derived DEM, USGS topo maps, and high-resolution aerial imagery.
- **Hydric Soils**: NRCS Web Soil Survey and SSURGO data.

There are approximately 1.37 acres of potential wetlands reported on the subject site. The wetland areas are located along the eastern boundary of the site and classified as "riverine" wetlands. Riverine wetlands depend on the flow of water conveyed by natural or artificial channels, including rivers, streams, ditches, and canals. They can form on floodplains, river terraces, and along channel beds, especially where the flows are seasonal or episodic. These wetlands play a critical role in absorbing runoff water and then slowly releasing it before it reaches rivers and streams, thus reducing downstream flooding. *According to the SSURGO Hydrologic Soil Group map, 17.7% of the total site has soils estimated to have hydric components. These soils are almost completely outside of the proposed buildable area and are located on the eastern portion of the site near the potential wetland areas. While no potential wetlands are reported within the buildable area, wetland permitting and mitigation may be required on the subject site. This appears to pose minimal development impediments to the site*. NWI potential wetlands map is provided as **Appendix A**.

Soils conditions are assessed to identify potential advantages and/or challenges that could have an impact on site design, construction, and overall use of the site. Soil types are evaluated with respect to drainage and engineering performance for excavations, road construction, and building foundation support. Additionally, hydric soil ratings are used in conjunction with wetlands data to increase confidence in potential wetlands interpretation (reported in previous section).

According to the United States Department of Agriculture (USDA), Natural Resource Conservation Service (NRCS) Soil Survey Geographic Database (SSURGO) accessed via the NRCS Web Soil Survey, *68,0% (156.9 acres) of the subject site soils are classified as "Coupee silt loam, 0 to 2 percent slopes" with a drainage class of "Well drained." An additional 13.3% (30.5 acres) of the site has a rating of "well drained" with various types of Tracy sand loam and Troxel silt loam soils. Somewhat poorly drained to very poorly drained soil types including Bourbon sandy loam, Edwards muck, Palms muck, Pinhook loam, Sebewa loam, and Washtenaw silt loam make up the remaining 19.9% (43.2 acres) of the site.* These soils are assigned to SSURGO hydrologic soil groups and have slow infiltration rates with high runoff potential.

Soil suitability properties for small commercial building construction across 75.9% (174.9 acres) of the subject site are indicated as "Not limited" for shallow (2 feet deep) reinforced concrete spread footings. "Not limited" indicates that the soil has features that are very favorable for the specified use. The remaining 20.8% (47.9 acres) of the subject site is indicated as "Very limited" for shallow (2 feet deep) reinforced concrete footings. "Very limited" indicates that the soil has one or more features that are unfavorable for the



specified use. The limitations generally cannot be overcome without major soil reclamation, special design, or expensive installation procedures. Poor performance and high maintenance can be expected.

The majority of the buildable area has soils that are very favorable for an industrial project land use. Good performance and very low maintenance can be expected. The onsite areas that contain soils with poor drainage class, hydric soils group, and limited small commercial building construction rating are primarily located outside of the buildable area on the easternmost portion of the site. A SSURGO soils map is provided in **Appendix A**. The USDA, NRCR SSURGO soils reports for drainage class, small commercial buildings, and hydric rating are provided in **Appendix G**.

Sinkholes are common geological phenomenon occurring throughout the United States. They are only one of many kinds of karst landforms, which include caves, disappearing streams, springs, and underground drainage systems. Karst is a generic term which refers to the characteristic terrain produced by erosional processes associated with the chemical weathering and dissolution of limestone or dolomite.

The Sinkhole Areas and Sinking-Stream Basins Map developed by the Indiana Geological Survey shows the locations of sinkhole areas (SHA) and sinking-stream basins (SSB) in southern Indiana. Some sinkholes may exist outside the delineated areas, and some sinkholes may exist within the areas designated as sinking-stream basins, but such areas are not shown in this map. *The subject site lies entirely outside of the SHA and SSB areas, and thus should not be at risk of sinkholes.* The reliability of reported sinkhole occurrences is unknown. Potential site susceptibility to sinkholes must be determined through more thorough professional geological and geotechnical engineering investigation.

Zoning and Land Use is administered and governed by the City of La Porte and the 2017 Revised Joint Zoning Ordinance. *According to SSI Pre-Project Questionnaire, the site is currently zoned "M1" Light Industrial and "M2" Heavy Industrial. The City of La Porte online zoning map shows the site as being zoned "M1" Light Industrial.* A County Zoning Map is provided in **Appendix D.**

The apparent current land use of the subject site is derived from the 2017 City of La Porte Revised Joint Zoning Ordinance, recent aerial imagery, and Google Street View. *Recent aerial imagery shows current land use to be agricultural/vacant land as evidenced by minimal forested areas and lack of commercial structures. The aerial imagery-derived land use observations for the site agree with the 2017 City of La Porte Revised Joint Zoning Ordinance's Agricultural designation. It also matches with the NLC Database – Cultivated Crops (97%) land cover classifications.*

Current land use immediately surrounding the subject site to the north consists mainly of agricultural lands and municipal facilities, including a City of La Porte wastewater treatment plant and an Indiana Department of Transportation office/yard. There is also a small solar farm, several residential properties, and a church nearby. Agricultural lands are also observed to the east, west, and south. Limited single residential structures are observed along the site's western boundary.

There is little to no indication of other land uses over the last ninety-three years based on a review of historical aerial imagery dating to 1939 (provided by EDR Radius report). Thirteen epochs from 1939 to 2016 were reviewed to determine the sequential occupancy of the subject site. Since 1939, the subject site has been consistently used for agriculture. A small portion of the site near the southeast boundary was

previously forested as recently as 1973. The next available image from 1981 shows that the trees were removed. While the reason for the clearing of the trees is not determinate, no detrimental issue is suspected. Historical aerial imagery is included in the EDR Radius Report provided as **Appendix H**.

Current site land use is ideal to support future development of the site for Industrial land uses. Surrounding tract land use is compatible with the intended site use immediately around the buildable area. The land use is indicated from the 2017 City of La Porte Zoning Map to be Industrial to the north, Agricultural to the south and east, and Residential 1A to the west. *Tracts surrounding the subject site, and especially the buildable area, should be considered for rezoning with uses that are compatible with the intended industrial uses of the site. Compatibility with surrounding land use is vital to preserving the competitiveness of the site for an economic development use by preventing encroachment of land uses that would create real or perceived risk to prospective business considering the site for development.*

Relevant excerpts from the 2017 City of La Porte Revised Joint Zoning Ordinance prescribing zoning and land use polices, standards, and statutory requirements for land development are included in **Appendix D**. The 2017 City of La Porte Revised Joint Zoning Ordinance full documents should be consulted for detailed requirements pertaining to land use and zoning district designations.

Threatened and Endangered Species are defined under the federal Endangered Species Act (ESA) of 1973. The ESA provides a program for the conservation of threatened and endangered (T&E) plants and animals and the habitats in which they are found. The lead federal agencies for implementing ESA are the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service (USFWS) and the U.S. National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA) Fisheries Service. The USFWS maintains a worldwide list of endangered species. Species include birds, insects, fish, reptiles, mammals, crustaceans, flowers, grasses, and trees.

The ESA defines an *endangered species* as "any species which is in danger of extinction throughout all or a significant portion of its range." Endangered species are automatically protected by prohibitions of several types of "take," including harming, harassing, collecting, or killing, under Section 9 of the ESA. There are some limited exceptions to these rules listed in Section 10 of the ESA. The ESA defines a *threatened species* as "any species which is likely to become an endangered species within the foreseeable future throughout all or a significant portion of its range." Threatened species receive protections through separate regulations issued under Section 4(d) of the ESA.

LL+D staff consulted the USFWS Information for Planning and Consultation (IPaC) online tool (https://ipac.ecosphere.fws.gov/) to assess potential project effect on listed species (*a plant or animal that receives federal protections under the Endangered Species Act. Species can be protected as endangered or threatened*) and other USFWS trust resources (*includes migratory birds, species listed as threatened and endangered under the Endangered Species Act, interjurisdictional fishes, marine mammals, wetlands, and lands managed by USFWS, such as national wildlife refuges*). The IPaC tool is a project planning tool that streamlines the USFWS environmental review process.

An IPaC Resource List was generated for the subject site. The Resource List is a report that automatically generates a list of species and other resources such as critical habitat (collectively referred to as trust resources) under USFWS jurisdiction that are known or expected to be on or near the project area

referenced below. The list may also include trust resources that occur outside of the project area, but that could potentially be directly or indirectly affected by activities in the project area. However, determining the likelihood and extent of effects a project may have on trust resources typically requires gathering additional site-specific (e.g., vegetation/species surveys) and project-specific (e.g., magnitude and timing of proposed activities) information.

The IPaC trust resources report lists critical habitats and species of concern known or suspected to be found in habitats within regional ecology. The IPaC trust resources report found that the following species may potentially be affected by activities in this location:

- **Mammals**:
  - Indiana Bat (*Myotis sodalist*) – Endangered
  - Northern Long-eared Bat (*Myotis septentrionalis*) – Threatened
- **Insects**:
  - Monarch Butterfly (*Danaus plexippus*) – Candidate
- **Critical Habitats**:
  - There are no critical habitats at this location.

The IPaC report also identifies the Migratory Birds Resource List that identifies certain birds protected under the Migratory Bird Treaty Act of 1918 and the Bald and Golden Eagle Protection Act of 1940. Birds listed in the report are birds of particular concern either because they occur on the USFWS Birds of Conservation Concern (BCC) list or warrant special attention within the subject site location. The report does not include a list of every bird found within the site location, nor a guarantee that every bird on this list will be found within the site. The migratory bird list is derived from data provided by the Avian Knowledge Network (AKN). The AKN data is based on a growing collection of survey, banding, and citizen science datasets and is queried and altered to return a list of those birds reported as occurring in the 10km grid cell(s) that intersect the specified site study area location and have been identified as warranting special attention because they are a BCC species or an eagle (Eagle Protection Act requirements may apply) in that area.

The IPaC Migratory Birds Resource List (MBRL) provides a "Probability of Presence" summary indicating the best understanding of when birds of concern are most likely to be present in the site area. *While there is no immediate known impact to site development, the MBRL should be further reviewed within the context of environmental permitting requirements by a qualified environmental/ecological consultant, as temporal migratory bird presence may affect the timing of certain construction-related activities on the subject site*. The IPaC trust resources report is provided in **Appendix E**.

Legacy Environmental Concerns consist of historical activities and events both on the subject site and on nearby tracts where harmful contaminants were released into soil, surface water, and groundwater. If not properly remediated under state and federal regulatory requirements by qualified environmental consultants/contractors, historical contamination liabilities may be inherited through chain of title even if the contamination originated offsite, particularly with migration through groundwater transport. The historical environmental event implication for site development depends on many factors including the

type, extent, concentration, complexity, physical setting and surface/subsurface conditions, and time since the event, which may or may not pose a risk to prospective investors on site development.

A cursory review of the subject site and surrounding properties was conducted to identify any potential legacy environmental concerns. Informational resources consulted for this review include:

- EDR Radius Report;
- Recent and historical aerial imagery review;
- US Environmental Protection Agency's (EPA) Enforcement and Compliance History Online (ECHO) database (EDR Radius Report limits ECHO database search to the target property); and
- Information provided through interviews with local political officials, economic development representatives, and landowners (where available)

The EDR Radius Report searches environmental databases for permitted facilities, events, and other potential concerns occurring on the subject site and up to 1.0 mile of the site boundary. EDR use statement: "*A search of available environmental records was conducted by Environmental Data Resources, Inc (EDR). The report was designed to assist parties seeking to meet the search requirements of EPA's Standards and Practices for All Appropriate Inquiries (40 CFR Part 312), the ASTM Standard Practice for Environmental Site Assessments (E 1527-13), the ASTM Standard Practice for Environmental Site Assessments for Forestland or Rural Property (E 2247-16), the ASTM Standard Practice for Limited Environmental Due Diligence: Transaction Screen Process (E 1528-14) or custom requirements developed for the evaluation of environmental risk associated with a parcel of real estate*".

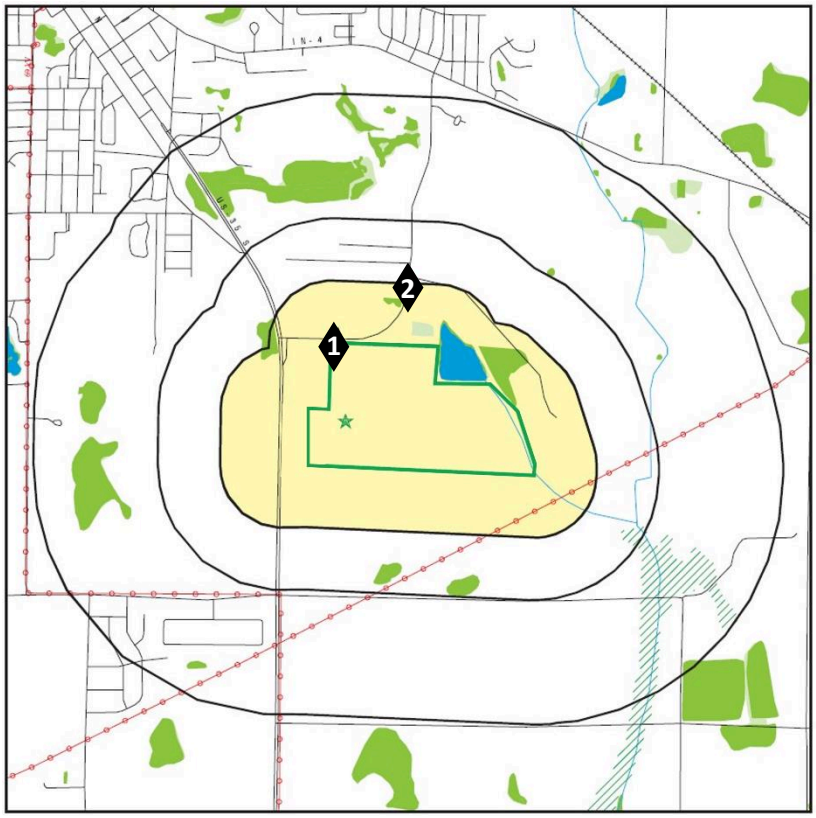
Based on the results of the EDR Radius Report and a cursory review of historical aerial imagery, two environmental legacy concerns were identified near the subject site. Two facilities appearing in multiple databases were identified within 0.25 miles of the subject site in the EDR Mapped Sites Summary:

- ***Resource Conservation and Recovery Act - Very Small Quantity Generator (RCRA-VSQG), Office of Indiana State Chemical Database (OISC), and the Industrial Waste Database***
  - *Site Name: INDOT LaPorte Subdistrict*
  - *Distance: within 200 feet*
  - *Elevation: higher (793' MSL)*
  - *Map ID*  *(overview map below)*

- ***Underground Storage Tank***
  - *Site Name: City of La Porte Sewage Department*
  - *Distance: within 0.25 miles*
  - *Elevation: lower (776' MSL)*
  - *Map ID* 

The facility referred to as INDOT LaPorte Subdistrict (Map ID #1) is located adjacent to the site's northwestern boundary on East Boyd Blvd. The Indiana Department of Transportation: LaPorte Subdistrict facility is located across East Boyd Blvd from the site, though not directly at the location of the EDR Radius Report's facility point. After a review of the recent and historical aerial imagery, it is likely that the placement of the point is inaccurate and that the point should be moved 500-1000' to the east on INDOT's

property. A review of the facility address in the EDR Radius Report shows 315 East Boyd Blvd, the same address as the INDOT facility. The INDOT LaPorte Subdistrict facility appears in multiple databases, including Resource Conservation and Recovery Act – Very Small Quantity Generator (RCRA-VSQG), Office of Indiana State Chemical Database (OISC), and the Industrial Waste Database.



EDR Radius Report Mapped Sites Overview Map

A very small quantity generator (VSQG) is any generator that generates the following amounts of hazardous waste in a calendar month: Less than 100 kilograms (220 pounds) of hazardous waste and less than 1 kilogram (2.2 pounds or 1 quart) of acute hazardous waste. VSQGs are recommended to manage hazardous waste in containers or tanks that are in good condition to prevent spills and releases to the environment that endangers human health.

The following hazardous waste codes are reported for the facility: ignitable waste, lead, and the following spent halogenated solvents: tetrachloroethylene, methylene chloride, trichloroethylene, 1,1,1-trichloroethane, chlorobenzene, 1,1,2-trichloro-1,2,2-trifluoroethane, ortho-dichlorobenzene, trichlorofluoromethane, and 1,1,2-trichloroethane. The existence of a VSQG adjacent to the subject site does not pose an environmental concern. All generators of hazardous waste are required to comply with management standards determined and outlined by the U.S. EPA's Resource Conservation and Recovery Act (RCRA). The generator regulations ensure that hazardous waste is appropriately identified and handled safely to protect human health and the environment. A review of the aerial imagery indicates that there is no treatment or disposal of hazardous waste on-site. There is also no mention of any violations of EPA standards in the EDR Radius report.

The City of La Porte Sewage Department facility (Map ID #2) is located just north of the site's northeastern boundary. The facility is reported to have two underground storage tanks (USTs) on site that are currently in use. Both tanks were installed on November 8th, 1988, the first a 1,000-gallon gasoline tank and the second a 2,000-gallon diesel tank. The USTs are registered with the state department and are regulated under Subtitle I of the RCRA. This facility should not pose an environmental concern for the subject site

since there is no record of petroleum-related contamination associated with the cited facilities. However, the extent of potential contamination resulting from the cited facilities may not be fully understood without conduction of more extensive environmental site investigations by a qualified consultant. Full facility information is provided in EDR Radius Report is provided as **Appendix H**.

As the EDR Radius report limits environmental database searches to the subject site and within 1.0 mile of the subject site, the EPA ECHO database was consulted for potential significant environmental concerns within 2.0 miles of the site including active permitted facilities operating under the EPA Clean Water Act, Title V of the Clean Air Act, or the Resource Conservation and Recovery Act (RCRA) for control of solid waste. In limited instances, new air permit applications can be subject to more stringent requirements based on nearby existing permitted facilities' total air emission pollutant volumes and concentrations.

ECHO search results reported one facility within a 2-mile radius of the subject site that is currently in violation of environmental regulations. The facility is the City of La Porte Wastewater Treatment Plant and there have been six reported violations of the Clean Water Act over the last three years. No significant violations or enforcement actions have been reported. All wastewater treatment plants (WWTPs) must comply with their National Pollutant Discharge Elimination System (NPDES) permit effluent limits. It cannot be determined if harmful contaminants have been released into the soil and/or groundwater on the subject site. Many factors should be considered including the contamination type, extent, concentration, complexity, physical setting and surface/subsurface conditions, and time since the event. LL+D recommends that a Phase I Environmental Site Assessment (ESA) be conducted to ensure that no contamination issues are present on site.

The NPDES permit program addresses water pollution by regulating point sources that discharge pollutants to waters of the United States. Created in 1972 by the Clean Water Act, the NPDES permit program is authorized to state governments by EPA to perform many permitting, administrative, and enforcement aspects of the program. Pollutants commonly discharged by small WWTPs at SNC violation levels include oxygen-demanding substances (e.g., biochemical oxygen demand (BOD), chemical oxygen demand (COD)), total suspended solids (TSS), pathogens (i.e., fecal coliform/E. coli), nutrients, and total residual chlorine. Small systems often have difficulty keeping trained operators and obtaining adequate funding for operations, maintenance, and system upgrades needed to achieve and maintain compliance.

Based on the expanded ECHO search, no environmental legacy concerns were identified on the subject site. The ECHO site search results are provided in **Appendix H**.

As with any desktop research exercise, actual potential environmental concerns may not be fully recognized or understood without conducting an on-site field investigation. The industry standard for real estate environmental review is the Phase I Environmental Site Assessment (ESA). Governed by the ASTM E1527: *Standard Practice for Environmental Site Assessments: Phase I Environmental Site Assessment Process.* The Phase I ESA is designed to investigate property prior to ownership transfer or improvements for use to identify and document any existing or potential contamination that must be addressed or give cause for liability. The Phase I ESA methodology includes more detailed research and review of environmental databases, historical aerial imagery, title research, and on-site field observations of the subject site and immediately surrounding properties.

Connection

Site connectivity includes access to key transportation assets and utility infrastructure sufficient for the use intensity of the subject site. Access to available workforce is also measured within the context of the intended economic development project use (e.g., heavy industrial, light industrial, commercial/freight logistics, etc.). *The Barr Industrial Property is well connected to transportation and utility assets with close proximity to local utilities access (potable water, sewer, electric, natural gas, and telco/broadband). In conjunction with strong community support and adequate workforce availability, the site is well positioned for competitive response to light industrial/manufacturing project opportunities*.

Transportation Assets are in place to serve the logistical needs of commercial/industrial business operations in the area. *Substantial transportation connections to the site include multilane divided U.S. highway frontage and direct access.*

Access to the site is currently available via East Boyd Blvd, a two-lane highway that runs along the western half of the site's northern boundary. A single point of ingress/egress can be constructed along East Boyd Blvd. From the site, truck traffic must travel approximately 0.25 miles west on East Boyd Blvd to access U.S. Highway 35 (US-35), a minor arterial highway. Traffic must then travel 7.0 miles north to reach Indiana Toll Road, Interstate 80/90 (I-80/90). US-35 is a four-lane highway at the site's western boundary, but after traveling 1.0 mile north from its intersection with East Boyd Blvd, the road becomes a two-lane highway. Traffic must travel through the heart of the City of La Porte on US-35 before turning onto State Highway 39 (IN-39), then drive 2.9 miles on IN-39 to reach I-80/90. While all roadways leading to interstate access appear to be in good condition and suitable for truck traffic, the 7.0-mile distance from the site is considered a challenge for certain industry types. Site access map is included in **Appendix A**.

Truck Routes accessible by the site include US-35 for immediate north-south travel and I-80/90 located approximately 7.0 miles to the north for east-west travel. I-80/90 is a toll road. I-94 access is located 10.0 miles northwest of the site and is an alternate route for east-west travel. Both I-80/90 and I-94 can be taken west for 68.4 and 71.2 miles, respectively, to reach Chicago and multiple other truck routes including I-65, I-57, I-55, I-88, US-41, US-52, and US-34. Multiple US-Highway routes can be taken to get to Indianapolis, including US-35 to US-31, US-35 to US-421, and US-35 to various state roads and I-65. Each of these routes trend generally southward and eventually connect to I-465 as well as various other truck routes including I-74, I-70, and I-69. The routes to Indianapolis are all between 140 and 160 miles from the site to the heart of Indianapolis. Having so many available truck routes is considered a strength for the site. However, being 7.0-miles from interstate access and potentially having to navigate through the City of La Porte is considered a challenge. A transportation vicinity map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Railroads do not currently extend to the subject site and are not required for the intended light industrial/manufacturing project uses of the site. The nearest railroad is a Chicago South Shore & South Bend Railroad (CSS) short line approximately 1.4 miles in direct linear measure northeast of the site. There is also a Norfolk Southern line 2.5 miles northwest and a Canadian National line

3.0 miles southeast in direct linear measure of the site boundary. It is not considered economically feasible to pull a rail spur into the site. A transportation vicinity map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Airport access is beneficial for both corporate executive and other business-related representatives travel to a facility during construction and when operational. Cargo airport access provides opportunity for transportation of process input materials and product distribution.

South Bend International Airport (SBN) is a freight and commercial airport located within 26.2 miles (~33-minute drive time). It is the closest airport to the subject site. SBN has three asphalt runways measuring 4,300 by 75 feet, 8,414 by 150 feet, and 7,100 by 150 feet. Within Indiana, the airport is second in passenger enplanements (417,929) after Indianapolis International (4,375,317). In 2019 the airport handled 47,756 aircraft operations, averaging 130 per day. The airport's proximity to the site is considered a significant strength for the Barr Industrial Property.

Gary/Chicago International Airport (GYY) is located 42.8 miles west of the subject site (~55-minute drive). The airport has an 8,859-ft runway, which is the 2nd longest in the region and can handle planes up to and including a 777, one of the largest planes in the world. It is a full-service airport with commercial charter, corporate and cargo flights that support the general aviation needs of LaPorte County.

The Chicago Midway International Airport (MDW) is located 73.6 miles west of the site (~1 hour and 40-minute drive). Midway is a major commercial airport, one of the busiest airports in the nation, and the second-busiest airport both in the Chicago metropolitan area and the state of Illinois, serving 7,669,456 passengers in 2021. The Chicago Midway International Airport covers just over one square mile and has five runways.

The Indianapolis International Airport (IND) is approximately 145.0 miles south (~2 hour and 45-minute drive) of the subject site. IND is home to the second largest FedEx Express hub in the world and was ranked as the sixth busiest U.S. airport in terms of air cargo throughput in 2020.

Seaport access is not required for the intended light industrial/manufacturing project uses of the site. However, the nearest seaport is Burns Harbor located within approximately 30 miles (~40-minute drive) west of the site. Burns Harbor is a port focused on steel, agriculture, and manufacturing located on Lake Michigan in the heart of the steel industry.

Utility Infrastructure is optimal for the subject site. The City of La Porte provides water service and sewer lines, NIPSCO provides natural gas and electric service, and Surf Internet provides fiber internet access. Water, sewer, natural gas, and electric lines are all located adjacent to the site. Water, sewer, and natural gas lines run along the site's northern boundary along East Boyd Blvd with an additional natural gas main running along US-35. There is also a pipeline easement located along the site's southern boundary. Electric distribution lines are adjacent to the site along with transmission lines located within 1 mile. Fiber-optic access is located 2,000 feet from the site with plans to extend infrastructure adjacent to the site by 2023. The utility service points of access for extending services to the site are located along the site's northern boundary. Site utility information obtained from the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" is

provided as **Appendix J**. Additional utility information obtained from the Barr Industrial Property Overview Flyer can be found in **Appendix L**. An energy infrastructure and utility access point map is provided as **Appendix A**.

Potable Water is provided by an existing 18" municipal main line that is operated by the City of La Porte and runs along East Boyd Blvd near the site's northern boundary. The line has an express capacity of 3 million gallons per day (MGD). Wells with the ability to deliver 12 MGD were recently installed at the end of 2021 according to the Barr Industrial Property Overview flyer. Current and proposed water service flow/capacities should be verified on a project-by-project basis with local water utility officials. Information provided by LaPorte County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Sewer/Wastewater is available to the subject site with an adjacent 36" municipal line that is operated by the City of La Porte and runs along East Boyd Blvd near the site's northern boundary. At least 2 MGD excess capacity is available for sanitary sewer service. The La Porte Wastewater Treatment Plant (WWTP) is located just north of the site. The treatment facility effluent is available for reuse. Travis Ditch, a county drain, is also adjacent to the property for storm water discharge. Current and proposed capacities should be verified on a project-by-project basis with local sanitary sewage utility officials. Information provided by LaPorte County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Natural Gas is available via a 10" distribution main with up to 60 psig west of the subject site along US-35, and a 2-inch distribution main with up to 60 psig north of the site along East Boyd Blvd. Natural gas service is provided by NIPSCO. High volume natural gas delivery capability exists and should be able to support large natural gas consumption projects. Information provided by LaPorte County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Electric power is provided by NIPSCO with 12.5kV electric distribution lines adjacent to the site and 69kV transmission lines within 1 mile. The nearest substations identified by public data from the US Energy Information Administration (EIA) are located approximately 2.5 miles to the north of the site in the City of La Porte. Total available MW capacity for the substations is unknown at the time of this report. Information provided by LaPorte County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Telco/Broadband distribution is provided to the site by Surf Internet, a fiber-optic internet company that serves the Great Lakes region of Illinois, Indiana, and Michigan. Fiberoptic infrastructure is located 2,000 linear feet from the site. Surf plans to expand their infrastructure adjacent to the site by 2023 to provide Symmetrical Gig speeds. Information provided by LaPorte

County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Major Market Areas are accessible within a two-hour drive of the subject site. By vehicular travel, the site is situated 68.7 miles from Chicago to the west and 151 miles from Indianapolis to the southeast with 2021 total populations of 2,696,555 and 882,039, respectively. Travel distances to major markets and seaports are provided below. A major market vicinity map is provided as **Appendix A.**

Time and Distance to Major Markets

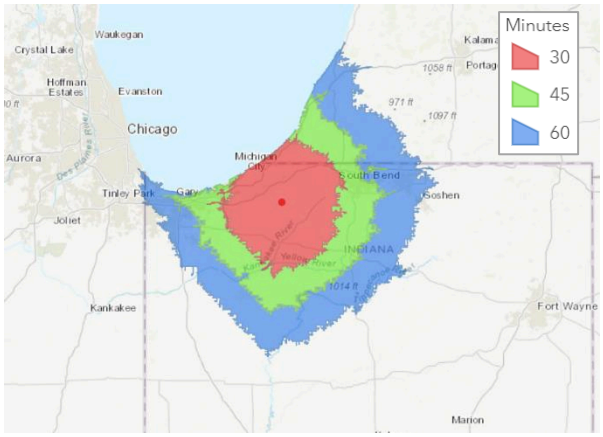
Major Markets	Travel Time	Miles
Chicago, IL	1:20	68.7
Fort Wayne, IN	1:53	100
Indianapolis, IN	2:42	151
Milwaukee, WI	2:47	159
Toledo, OH	2:50	183
Detroit, MI	3:23	229
Cincinnati, OH	3:57	256
Louisville, KY	4:07	266
Cleveland, OH	4:16	283
Columbus, OH	4:23	262
St. Louis, MO	4:57	339
Lexington, KY	5:08	330
Nashville	6:33	441

Time and Distance to Ports

Ports of Indiana	Travel Time	Miles
Burns Harbor	0:40	30.2
Jeffersonville	4:19	265
Mount Vernon	5:41	315

Community

Community aspects conducive to site competitiveness include both measurable and intangible factors that can either strengthen or undermine a site's inherent competitive advantages. While workforce availability and cultural features are commonly accounted for, business and political climate are often neglected, yet serve as an important indicator for both community and governmental desired to welcome new business investment. The LaPorte County community and political leadership are strong proponents of business growth and new job creation, creating a business climate highly conducive to project investment support through



30, 45, 60-minute Drive-time Employment Query

efficient permitting, workforce training, and competitive tax structures. LaPorte County is committed to supporting long-term industrial and commercial business operations in its communities.

Description of the Economy

LaPorte County is located in Indiana, a state that boasts a business-friendly environment, solid infrastructure, and substantial creation of manufacturing jobs. The county falls within the Northwest region of Indiana and has a population of 112,390 (US Census Bureau). La Porte, the county seat, has a population of 22,383 (US Census Bureau). The largest city in the county is Michigan City with a 2021 population of 32,033. The county's strong manufacturing history and commitment to industry helps to drive local drive economic growth. It is also influenced by the smaller metropolitan regional center of South Bend. LaPorte County is part of the Chicago Metropolitan Statistical Area (MSA), an area that spans 19 counties throughout the Midwestern United States and had a 2020 census population of 9,618,502. Further information about LaPorte County population and economic trends can be found in the 2008 Countywide Land Development Plan, provided as **Appendix M.**

Demographics

LaPorte County had a 2010 population density of approximately 186 persons per square mile, close to the state average of 181 ppsm, and is the sixteenth most populated county in the State of Indiana. In the last five years, LaPorte County experienced a population growth rate of 2%. The population, considering race alone or in combination with one other race, is roughly 86.0% White, 13.2% Black or African American, 0.9% Asian, 0.7% Native American, and 2.6% some other race. Approximately 6.6% of the population are Hispanic or Latino. The county's median age is 40.3.

Employment and the Economy and Income

LaPorte County, IN is home to a highly engaged and skilled local workforce with a total resident labor force of approximately 50,768 people. Unemployment (3.5%) is slightly higher than the state average (3.1%). Manufacturing; Educational Services, Health Care & Social Assistance; and Retail Trade make up the largest industries in the county, employing 21.8%, 21.3%, and 11.8% of workers, respectively. The Manufacturing sector employs 10,395 people; Educational Services, Health Care & Social Assistance employs 10,145 people; and Retail Trade employs 5,611 people. The highest paying industries in LaPorte County, by median earnings, are Utilities, Transportation and Warehousing, and Manufacturing, with 2019 median annual earnings of $73,750, $50,365, and $49,626, respectively. According to county officials, the county average wage is $44,189. Median household income is $53,658, which is less than the median annual income of $62,843 across the United States.

Population/Workforce *within a 60-minute drive time from the site include a total population of more than 1,338,307 and 46,056-plus businesses employing over 632,182 people according to Esri 2022 demographic data. Construction, manufacturing, and professional, scientific, & technical services account for 19.4% of businesses employing 29.3% of total workforce within the 60-mile radius of the site*. A 30, 45, and 60-minute drive-time query of employment numbers for construction and manufacturing jobs (by NAICS Code) was performed for the subject site. The following employment numbers were reported:

30, 45, 60-minute Drive-time Employment Count*

Business Type by NAICS Codes	Employees		
	30-min	45-min	60-min
Construction	5,489	17,860	37,492
Manufacturing	16,464	56,211	129,104
Professional, Scientific & Tech Services	3,363	13,438	25,409
Totals	**25,316**	**87,509**	**192,005**

**Source: Copyright 2022 Infogroup, Inc. All rights reserved. Esri Total Residential Population forecasts for 2022.*

LaPorte County target industries include film manufacturers, compressor manufacturers and service providers, injection molders (especially automotive related), and cast parts, with a priority placed on high wage jobs. With access to a total workforce of over 654,432 which includes 192,005-plus employed in construction, manufacturing, and professional, scientific, and technical services sectors, adequate workforce availability should meet medium to large-scale project labor demands of county industry targets. Population and business summary reports are provided in **Appendix I**.

Cultural Features within three miles of the subject site that may pose community risk or public opposition to industrial development are limited and generally do not affect site permitting, construction, or facility operation. Fire and police protection and emergency medical services are within relatively close proximity of the subject site, however, located in the town of Bronson, these facilities do not pose cross-transportation risks for site construction or facility operation. A cultural features map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Schools are concentrated within the municipal limits of the City of La Porte. There are three elementary schools, two middle schools, one high school, and one day care center within three miles of the subject site. The Kesling Intermediate School is located about a mile northwest of the subject site across U.S. Highway 35 (US-35). The school appears relatively large compared to other surrounding schools, and US-35 may be an access route for some students. Still, with the site over a mile away and truck traffic having access to a four-lane highway, the school should not pose any issues to site development. The Door Prairie Adventist School & Day Care is located about 0.75 miles north of the site on Boyd Blvd. While the site's access road does overlap with the school access route, the poses no significant operational proximity or transportation risk to the day care.

Churches are largely concentrated within the municipal limits of the City of La Porte and the surrounding areas. There are forty-one churches within three miles of the subject site buildable area. Three of these churches are within a half mile of the site and one is adjacent to the site's northeastern boundary. The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-Day Saints on US-35 and First Pentecostal Church on East Boyd Blvd should be sufficiently removed from the operational footprint of the site (e.g., buildable area). As such, the site poses no significant operational proximity or transportation risks to these churches. The closest church to the site, La Porte

Assembly of God, is adjacent to the site's northwestern boundary. The proposed buildable area has approximately 200' of buffer between the site's operational footprint and the church. It is LL+D's opinion that sufficient buffer exists to provide relief from noise and light pollution and facility line of sight from the vantage point of church location. It is known to the church membership that the subject site has historically been and is currently zoned for industrial use. As such, adequate distance and vegetative buffer should mediate most development objections. LL+D recommends that at least a 520-foot long buffer consisting of newly planted evergreen and deciduous trees and shrubs native to the region be planted along the subject site property line that is adjacent to the church to provide the necessary vegetative buffering.

Cemeteries do not exist immediately proximate to the site or along principal site access routes. One cemetery is within three miles of the site buildable area, though this poses no risk to site permitting or operation.

Group Care Centers including nursing homes, assisted living centers, special education schools, crisis units, and hospice facilities do not exist immediately proximate to the site or along principal site access routes. Five assisted living facilities are located within 3 miles of the subject site. The closest facility, Settler's Place, is located on Monroe St about 1.4 miles from the site.

Other Cultural Centers including libraries, museums and art galleries, movie theaters and performing arts centers, zoos and aquariums, arboreta and botanical gardens, and planetariums do not exist immediately proximate to the site. The LaPorte County Historical Society Museum is located on US-35, a principal site access route. The museum is about a half mile from the site and should not pose a threat to industrial development.

Parks and Protected Lands do not exist immediately proximate to the site or along principal site access routes. The Kesling Park baseball/softball field, tennis complex and walking trail is located about a mile west of the site across US-35. This area is sufficiently removed from the operational footprint of the site (e.g., buildable area) and is buffered by agricultural lands. Site ingress/egress road access does not intersect or share park access. A protected lands map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Correctional Facilities including federal, state, and local prisons and detention centers do not exist immediately proximate to the site or along principal site access routes. The LaPorte County Jail and the Laporte County Community Corrections Center are both located in the City of La Porte about 3 miles from the site.

Fire Protection/EMS is provided by the La Porte Fire Department Station 1 located within a 2.0 mile driving distance of the site access point. The response route is roughly 4-minutes, with trucks taking 18th St, Crescent Dr, and US-35 to East Boyd Blvd. The Scipio Twp Volunteer Fire Department Station 2 is another option located 2.9 miles and a 5-minute drive from the site with the response route running from West 250 South to US-35 and East Boyd Blvd. The La Porte Fire Department Station 3 is also located 2.9 miles and an 8-minute drive from the site. Trucks taking

this route must pass through residential areas in the city of La Porte before turning onto US-35 and East Boyd Blvd. Fire and EMS response time and capacity should be locally verified.

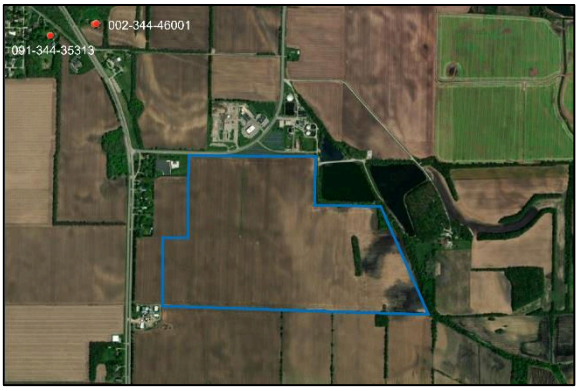
Law Enforcement is provided by the La Porte Police Department located within 2.0 miles of the site boundary/buildable area. The response route is US-35 to East Boyd Blvd and is approximately a 3-minute drive time from the site. The Laporte County Sheriff's Office is located 2.5 miles and a 5-minute drive from the site access point. Law enforcement response time and capacity should be locally verified.

Hospital/Emergency Care is provided by two different hospitals within 3-miles of the subject site: Northwest Health and Franciscan Beacon Hospital. Northwest Health is located 2.8 miles (~5-minute drive time) from the site via Tyler St, Lincoln Hwy, and US-35 to East Boyd Blvd. It is an acute care hospital with 74 total staffed beds. Franciscan Beacon Hospital is located 2.8 miles (~6-minute drive time) from the site via Indiana SR-2, 5th St, Plummer St, and US-35 to East Boyd Blvd. The hospital is an acute care hospital and 24/7 ER with a 10-bed emergency department and 8 inpatient beds.

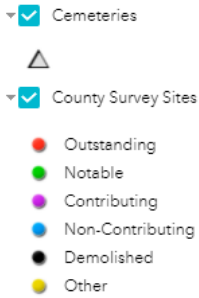
Historical Preservation records include locations of cultural or archaeological significance, some of which are formally designated as state and/or federally protected historical resources under State Historic Preservation Offices (SHPO) and/or National Register of Historic Places registrations. Historical resources, if located on the subject site, may alter, impede, or preclude development if potential for disturbance or encroachment exists. Historical resources located near the subject site may warrant mitigating site planning and design elements such as line-of-site buffering between facilities and a historically significant structure. The Indiana Department of Natural Resources (IDNR) houses the Division of Historic Preservation and Archaeology (DHPA), which promotes the conservation of Indiana's cultural resources. The DHPA facilitates state and federal preservation programs and is the staff of the State Historic Preservation Office. The DHPA's Archaeology Team administers programs for protecting and preserving Indiana's prehistoric and historic archaeological sites, is the central repository of archaeological records and reports, and houses the state's official computerized database of archaeological site information.

Several cultural resource GIS datasets from the IDNR were consulted for potential location of culturally or historically significant resources on or near the subject site. These datasets are collected and contained within the State Historic Architectural and Archaeological Research Database (SHAARD), which allows users to search cultural resource information on known historic and archaeological resources throughout the State of Indiana. SHAARD includes data from the Indiana Historic Sites and Structures Inventory county survey (IHSSI), the Indiana Cemetery and Burial Ground Registry, historic bridges and canals, historic theaters, and properties listed in the National Register of Historic Places and the Indiana Register of Historic Sites and Structures. The data contained in SHAARD was collected from previously conducted cultural resource inventories, National Register nominations, and cultural resource management projects. SHAARD and associated resource maps are ongoing initiatives and are updated daily, so the absence of data does not necessarily indicate the absence of resources. A more formal archaeological survey may be necessary prior to site development.

A desktop data review was conducted regarding available records for potential cultural resources present on the subject property. *The SHAARD database identified no archaeological sites and no historic structures on the subject site. Two historic structures identified as the "Marion Ridgeway Barn" and the "Ridgeway Farm" are reported within 1 mile of the subject site. The reported structures (Survey Numbers 002-344-46001 and 091-344-35313 respectively) shown on the corresponding SHAARD web application map are located in close proximity to US-35 and Crescent Drive, approximately 0.7 miles north of the subject site. Both structures are listed as "Outstanding" historic buildings. Neither structure should present significant impediments to development of the subject site. All other historically significant resources are located outside the 1-mile buffer surrounding the subject site boundary and are not likely to impact site development potential.* The SHAARD/IHSSI Reports for both structures are provided as **Appendix K**, and the Historic Resource search map is provided as **Appendix A**.



SHAARD Map Search



As with any desktop research exercise, actual potential historic preservation concerns may not be fully recognized or understood without conducting an on-site field investigation. The industry standard for real estate environmental review is the Phase I Cultural Resources Survey. The primary objective of a Phase I archaeological survey is to identify and record all cultural resources within a project area. Cultural resources can include prehistoric Native American habitation sites, historic farmstead sites, standing structures, or other man-made features such as earthworks, old roadbeds, or cemeteries. The Phase I survey process typically begins with Phase IA Archaeological Reconnaissance to conduct historical research, environmental context review, and field inspection. When an archaeological site is encountered, a full written report must be submitted following guidance provided in the Current Guidebook for Indiana Historic Sites and Structures Inventory—Archaeological Sites and the Indiana Cultural Resources Manual.

Indiana Code 14-21-1 provides protection for archaeological sites and historic burial sites regardless of their location on state or private lands. All archaeological sites with artifacts dating before December 31, 1870 are protected under this act. Human burial sites are afforded protection under IC 14-21-1, IC 14-21-2, IC 23-14 (Indiana General Cemetery Act). The State of Indiana implements specialized reviews that provide protection to historic properties on state-owned or leased land or to historic properties that are listed in the National Register of Historic Places or the Indiana Register of Historic Sites and Structures and that will be altered, demolished, or removed using state funds. These review processes are established in Sections 14, 16, and 18 of Indiana Code 14-21-1. In addition, projects that will disturb the ground within 100 feet of a cemetery or burial ground for the purpose of excavating or covering the ground or erecting, altering, or repairing any structure are reviewed in Sections 26-26.5. In order to increase the confidence in understanding any potential historical preservation concerns for the subject site, it is recommended that a Phase I archaeological survey be conducted by a qualified cultural resource

management/archaeological consulting professional and that archaeology state laws listed in Title 14, Article 21 of the Indiana Code are thoroughly understood. Relevant sections of the Indiana Code are provided as **Appendix K.** Information regarding Indiana Archaeology Law, complete with links to the full Indiana Code and Indiana Administrative Code, is also provided as **Appendix K.**

Education and Technical Training Assets are well positioned to serve professional and technical workforce needs of LaPorte County target industries, while colleges and universities provide valuable recruiting opportunities to local businesses.

The Indiana Department of Workforce Development (DWD) offers a variety of services to statewide job seekers looking to enter the workforce, return to the workforce, or locate education and training opportunities. These include Hoosier Talent Network, INDemand Jobs, Indiana Career Explorer, Indiana Career Connect, Cyberseek Indiana, and Indiana Career Ready. The DWD offers several services including job search help, hiring events, training grants, specialized training and more: https://www.in.gov/dwd/.

Indiana's WorkOne Career Centers are the heart of the workforce development system, providing assistance in understanding jobs in demand today, helping workers determine their interests and abilities, offering access to training opportunities, and providing information needed to succeed in today's economy. WorkOne's Job Opportunities and Business Services (JOBS) Program assists employers in locating and developing a skilled team by determining eligibility, recruiting employees, formulating WorkKeys job profiles, and providing skills assessments to identify gaps and training needs. WorkOne's WIN Career Readiness is a fundamental workplace skills training system available to Indiana residents, employers and training providers. Both the DWD's Work Opportunity Tax Credit (WOTC) and Federal Bonding Program benefits employers by offering incentives for hiring jobseekers who may traditionally have difficulty finding employment.

Next Level Jobs provides free training for Indiana workers and reimbursements for Indiana employers for training employees in high-demand fields. Next Level Jobs assists job seekers by providing Indiana residents with free training in high-growth job fields and the opportunity for them to earn a high-value certificate in one of Indiana's in-demand job fields, tuition free. Next Level Jobs assists employers with reimbursements for training their employees through the Employer Training Grant, which will reimburse an employer for up to $5,000 per trained employee who is trained, hired, and retained for six months, granting up to $50,000 per employer.

The Center of Workforce Innovations is a non-profit corporation dedicated to addressing workforce development needs. The Center acts on behalf of the Local Workforce Investment Board which serves several counties in Northwest Indiana, providing education resources and workforce training assistance.

The University of Notre Dame du Lac (Notre Dame), a private Catholic research university outside the City of South Bend, is located within a 40-minute drive time of the site. Notre Dame has been recognized as one of the top universities in the United States and has been at the forefront in research and scholarship and had a total undergraduate enrollment of 8,874 in the fall of 2020. Valparaiso University is a private university located within a 30-minute drive time of the subject site and had an undergraduate enrollment of 2,723 in the fall of 2020.

Ivy Tech Community College is a two-year vocational/technical college with locations surrounding the site in the cities of South Bend, Michigan City, and Valparaiso. Ivy Tech specializes in developing programs geared towards specific skills needed for existing manufacturers and other industries. A healthcare-focused vocational education facilities, Ross Medical Education Center, is also located nearby in the City of South Bend.

Other higher education centers within 45 miles of the subject site include Purdue University's Northwest-Hammond Campus, Indiana Wesleyan University – Merrillville, Indiana University – South Bend, and Marian University's Ancilla College.

The site is within reach of several colleges and trade schools in the Chicago area, which is within an approximate 90-minute drive time, including the University of Illinois at Chicago, DeVry University Illinois, DePaul University, University of Chicago, Northwestern University, Loyola University Chicago, and Illinois Institute of Technology.

Business Climate is highly favorable for bringing in quality job-creating businesses to the area. Indiana is considered one of the best states in the nation for long-term fiscal stability and low corporate income tax rates, creating a business-forward environment throughout the state. The State of Indiana's target Industries according to the IEDC include advanced manufacturing, aerospace and aviation, ag-bioscience, defense, life sciences, logistics and transportation, and technology. These industries can take advantage of existing transportation assets throughout the state and county to serve an array of unique business logistical needs. The following target industries are listed by LaPorte County officials: film manufacturers, compressor manufacturers and service providers, injection molders (especially automotive related), and cast parts. There is a priority placed by the county on high wage paying jobs over a large quantity of jobs.

LaPorte County has a labor force of 50,768 and an unemployment rate of 3.5%. Business development and assistance is provided locally by LaPorte County Government via the La Porte Economic Advancement Partnership (LEAP) and the LaPorte County Office of Economic Development.

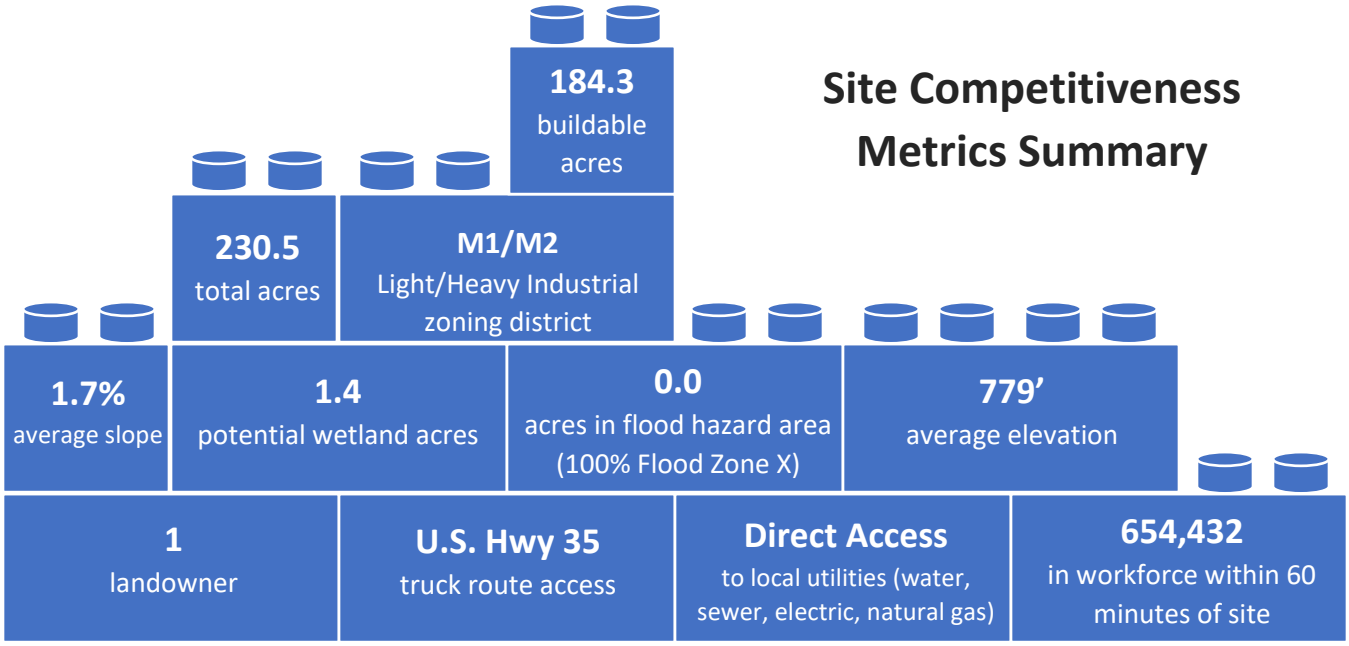
Local incentives include project financing support, access to trade zones, land acquisition and site preparation assistance, fast-track permitting process, utilities, and workforce development training. Both personal and real property abatements are available through LaPorte County and its cities. Tax abatement and Enterprise Zone incentives take approximately 60 days to implement. Tax Increment Financing (TIF), a method of facilitating development or redevelopment for a business by utilizing future tax revenues to pay for necessary improvements, is available and generally takes approximately six months to one year.

In addition, the IEDC provides for a variety of programs and initiatives offering business support and expertise to companies that are investing and creating jobs in Indiana. These include the Indiana Regional

Cities Initiative, Certified Technology Park program, Broadband Ready Communities program, and Next Level Roads program.

The State of Indiana offers a variety of incentives for all types of businesses, including targeted industries, workforce training, infrastructure and special opportunity incentives. Indiana's business tax structure is competitive—the corporate income tax is decreasing to 4.9%, and the state offers many business tax incentives, corporate tax credits and economic development programs. Statewide incentives include the Community Revitalization Enhancement District (CRED) Tax Credit, Data Center Gross Retail and Use Tax Exemption, Economic Development for a Growing Economy (EDGE) Tax Credit, Industrial Grant Fund (IDGF), Tax Exemption for Patent-derived Income, Skills Enhancement Fund (SEF), Venture Capital Investment Tax Credit program, Hoosier Business Investment (HBI) Tax Credit, Research Expense Credits, Research and Development Sales Tax Exemption, and Redevelopment Tax Credit (RTC).

Political Climate is strong according to interviews with local officials, and the community is largely in favor of commercial/industrial business development to bring long-term economic growth to the area, especially in advanced manufacturing sectors.



Site Competitiveness Report Card

The Site Competitiveness Report Card is an indicator of favorable development conditions across customary competitiveness factors. A relative score for each factor is given as a letter grade, akin to a 4.0 education grade point average (GPA). The GPA is calculated for each competitiveness area: Condition, Connection, and Community with an overall site GPA derived as a relative indicator of site competitiveness for an economic development land use.

Competitiveness Driver		
Condition	Comments	3.7
Engineering		
Elevation/Slope		A
Flood Risk		A
Buildable Configuration		A
Land Cover		A
Environmental/Cultural Resource		
Potential Wetlands		B+
Legacy Environmental Liabilities		B-
Potential T&E Risk		A
Connectivity		3.8
Transportation		
Interstate		B-
Multi-lane Truck Route		B
Class I Rail		N/A
Airport (passenger)		A
Airport (cargo)		A
Seaport/Inland Port		N/A
Utilities		
Potable Water		A
Sewer/Wastewater Treatment		A
Natural Gas		A
Electric		A
Broadband/Fiber		A
Community		3.8
Cultural		
Compatibility with Surrounding Land Use		A
Community Acceptance		A
Economic		
Market Vitality		A
Tax Incentives		B+
Labor		
Workforce		A
Wage Competitiveness		B+
Political		
Permitting Expediency		A
Business Climate		A

Site GPA

3.8

Rough Order-of-Magnitude Site Development Cost Summary

A rough order-of-magnitude (ROM) cost estimation for pre-construction site preparation and utility and transportation infrastructure improvements was calculated to provide a general understanding of potential site development costs. ROM costs were calculated for the 184.3-acre buildable area, which was devised to avoid more costly site leveling due to elevation/slope conditions occurring on the eastern-southeastern perimeter of the site. ROM cost tables for the buildable area are presented below.

Notes:

- *Does not include costs for engineering, permitting, or general project management.*
- *This cost estimate was prepared with the best information available at the time of analysis.*
- *Actual costs can vary based on availability of material, site conditions, and labor.*
- *ROM costs generated from GIS data and use of RSMeans construction cost estimating software.*

ROM Costs for 18091-010 Buildable Area (184.3 acres)

Project: 18157-001
Location: Tippacanoe, IN

WORK ACTIVITY	QUANTITY	UNIT	UNIT COST	SUBTOTAL	TOTAL
ON-SITE PREPARATION					
Site Clearing					
Mobilization	1.00	EA	$40,000.00	$40,000.00	
Demolition (Structure)	1.00	EA	$25,000.00	$25,000.00	
Clearing	5.00	AC	$2,500.00	$12,500.00	
Topsoil Strip/Cut	250066.67	CY	[illegible]	$577,654.00	
Total Site Clearing				$655,154.00	$655,154.00
Grading Cut					
Earth Cut	859393.00	[illegible]	$3.50	$3,007,875.50	
Total Grading Cut				$3,007,875.50	$3,007,875.50
Grading Fill					
Earth Fill	859393.00	CY	$3.50	$3,007,875.50	
Total Grading Fill				$3,007,875.50	$3,007,875.50
Other Preparation					
Fine Grading (Building)	[illegible].00	SY	$1.45	$0.00	
Fine Grading (Non-Building)	[illegible].00	SY	$0.95	$0.00	
Erosion Control	100.00	AC	$2,500.00	$250,000.00	
Seeding	300.00	AC	$1,250.00	$375,000.00	
Total Other Preparation				$625,000.00	$625,000.00
			TOTAL		**$7,295,905.00**
OFF-SITE IMPROVEMENTS					
Road Improvements					
Turning Lane Left (300')	1.00	EA	$196,086.42	$196,086.42	
Turning Lane Right (300')	1.00	EA	$189,320.60	$189,320.60	
Total Road Improvements				$385,407.02	$385,407.02
			TOTAL		**$385,407.02**

DRAFT

Project: 18157-001
Location: Tippacanoe, IN

WORK ACTIVITY	QUANTITY	UNIT	UNIT COST	SUBTOTAL	TOTAL
ON-SITE IMPROVEMENTS					
Paving - Asphalt					
Asphalt Paving - Drives (Light Duty)	0.00	SY	$19.06	$0.00	
Asphalt Paving - Drives (Heavy Duty)	83700.00	SY	$25.32	$2,119,551.84	
Total Paving - Asphalt				$2,119,551.84	$2,119,551.84
				TOTAL	**$2,119,551.84**
UTILITIES & DRAINAGE					
Water	4600.00	LF	$65.00	$299,000.00	
Sewer	3100.00	LF	$75.00	$232,500.00	
Subsurface Drainage	3100.00	LF	$132	$409,200.00	
Drainage Outfall	1.00	EA	$10 .00	$100,000.00	
3 Phase Electrical	3100.00	LF	$ .00	$585,900.00	
Total Utilities				$1,626,600.00	$1,626,600.00
				TOTAL	**$1,626,600.00**
RAIL					
Spur	300 .0	L	$500.00	$1,500,000.00	
Crossing	1.0	EA	$80,000.00	$80,000.00	
Switch	2.0	EA	$500,000.00	$1,000,000.00	
Total Rail Improvements				$2,580,000.00	$2,580,000.00
				TOTAL	**$2,580,000.00**
WETLAND MITIGATION(optional)					
Compensatory Mitigation (unverifi)	0.00	AC	$109,200.00	$0.00	
Total Mitigation (not indluding contr or costs)				$0.00	$0.00
				TOTAL	**$0.00**
				SUB-TOTAL	**$14,007,463.86**
			Construction Contingency	10%	$1,400,746.39
			Total Cost Estimate For Site Construction w/o Mitigation		**$15,408,210.25**
			Total Cost Estimate For Site Construction with Mitigation		**$15,408,210.25**
SOFT COSTS					
Engineering				9.00%	$1,386,738.92
Surveying & Staking				2.50%	$385,205.26
Testing & Inspecting				1.00%	$154,082.10
Construction Management				4.75%	$731,889.99
Studies					$100,000.00
				TOTAL	**$2,757,916.27**
				Total Cost Estimate For Site	**$18,166,126.51**

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Site Competitiveness Opinion

Overall, the Barr Industrial Property in the City of La Porte, LaPorte County presents a notable opportunity for industrial development.

The site has several competitive features that position it as a strategic real estate asset to support economic development. Firstly, the site has access to all major utilities including electricity, natural gas, wastewater & sewer, potable water, and broadband/fiber. The site also offers a large contiguous PAD of just below 200 acres that is mostly flat and dry with favorable soils for large-scale industrial development. There is a skilled workforce in the area and a population of nearly 1.35 million within a 60-minute drivetime. Proximity to several regional and international airports with freight and commercial services is another positive attribute. The site is in an ideal position for truck access with several different routes available to reach the nearby metropolitan areas of Indianapolis and Chicago including I-80/90 and I-94. There should not be any uncertainty regarding property availability, as LaPorte County economic development officials have confirmed that the landowner is actively promoting the site for sale. With industrial zoning in place and LaPorte County community and political leadership working together as strong proponents of business growth and new job creation, quick permitting expediency should also be expected. Finally, there are nearby hospitals, law enforcement, fire protection, and EMS to provide services to future on-site facilities.

Some challenges for the site also exist, including potential environmental legacy issues and the need to perform a Phase I Environmental Site Assessment (ESA), distance from interstate access, and the site's proximity to a place of worship. Currently when leaving the site, truck traffic must travel a minimum of 7.0 miles to access the interstate. While all roadways leading to interstate access appear to be in good condition and suitable for truck traffic, the 7.0-mile distance is considered a challenge. It is recommended that a focus be placed on attracting industries that have a tolerance for being without direct interstate access. Having direct access to a four-lane U.S. Highway and multiple different routes to large metropolitan areas should be sufficient in attracting a variety of desired industry types. Another potential challenge for the site is possible onsite contamination from the adjacent City of La Porte Wastewater Treatment Plant. The WWTP has received several violations of the Clean Water Act over the last three years and there is a risk for soil and/or groundwater contamination on the subject site. LL+D recommends that a Phase I Environmental Site Assessment (ESA) be conducted to ensure that no contamination issues are present on site. Lastly, to mediate any development objections, a vegetative buffer should be constructed between the subject site and a church adjacent to the site's northwestern boundary. LL+D recommends that a buffer consisting of newly planted evergreen and deciduous trees and shrubs native to the region be planted along the property line adjacent to the church to provide necessary vegetative buffering.

Upon considering the factors mentioned throughout the SSI Phase II Report, it is the opinion of LL+D that the Barr Industrial Property should be considered a nationally competitive site for attracting quality job-producing light industrial/manufacturing projects to LaPorte County. With direct access to all major utilities and a four-lane U.S. Highway, a large, flat, and dry buildable area, adequate workforce availability,

and landowner willingness and zoning in line with industrial development, the property should be considered a high-quality site that is prime for development.

Subject Site Key Facts

Advantages	Disadvantages
Well connected to all utility infrastructure assets (electric, natural gas, wastewater, and potable water)	ECHO search results found that the City of La Porte Wastewater Treatment Plant has received six violations of the Clean Water Act over the last three years. A Phase I Environmental Site Assessment (ESA) is recommended to ensure that no contamination issues are present on site.
Large buildable area of just under 200 contiguous acres (184.3 acres) is available	
Ideal land use to support development of light industrial/manufacturing project land uses.	While all roadways leading to interstate access appear to be in good condition and suitable for truck traffic, the 7.0-mile distance from the site is considered a challenge for certain industry types.
Close proximity to an international freight and commercial airport (South Bend International Airport).	
Site has low flood risk, no recorded or observed hydrography features, and minimal wetlands	Truck routes that lead to the interstate travel through the City of La Porte.
LaPorte County economic development officials have confirmed that the Landowner is actively promoting the site for sale	There is a church adjacent to the site's northwestern boundary. Adequate distance and vegetative buffer should mediate most development objections. LL+D recommends that at least a 520-foot long buffer consisting of newly planted evergreen and deciduous trees and shrubs native to the region be planted along the subject site property line that is adjacent to the church to provide the necessary vegetative buffering.
LaPorte County community and political leadership are strong proponents of business growth and new job creation creating a business climate highly conductive to project investment	
Current zoning of site and surrounding area is ideal to support future development of the site for industrial land uses	
Access to surrounding labor markets at competitive wage rates is well within reach of the subject site.	
Population of greater than 1.33 million within 60-minute drive time of the site	

Purpose and Use of Study

Sites originating from Phase I have demonstrated qualitative compliance with engineering. environmental, infrastructure, and cultural location criteria. That said, in order to develop an actionable understanding of true site competitiveness, a more detailed study of the subject site is required. SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence is designed for this purpose.

Purpose

The purpose of the SSI Phase II study is to provide an understanding of the subject site's advantages and challenges in conjunction with a ROM cost estimate to improve site functional use and mitigate development challenges. The SSI Phase II study is a desktop-based preliminary due diligence exercise performed by discipline-specific experts with experience in industrial and commercial property development. Study of the subject site's physical and surrounding characteristics, assets, and impediments for development are reviewed in sufficient detail to formulate a defendable opinion on the competitive value of the property for economic development.

Use

There are three primary intended uses of an SSI Phase II report: (1) site advancement decision support; (2) consideration for investment in site improvements; and (3) site marketing. Each intended use is discussed below.

Site Advancement Decision

The SSI Phase II study is designed to provide decision support for the advancement of sites to market though the landowner engagement process. SSI Phase II findings serve as an indicator for the likelihood the subject site will survive the intensive scrutiny of formal, field-based engineering and environmental due diligence. Detection of severe site deficiencies or encumbrances, often referred to as fatal flaws, during desktop preliminary due diligence can avoid expenditure of significant resources in subjecting sites with little chance of survival to formal due diligence. Short of fatal flaws, SSI Phase II may reveal less than ideal conditions or less severe yet concerning challenges that can marginalize site competitiveness or be detrimental to business attraction, respectively. The most important use of the SSI Phase II study is to ensure confidence in the decision to advance sites to market graduation through subsequent phases for landowner engagement and formal due diligence. *Ultimately, site advancement decisions should be tempered by local industry targets and the host community's real estate needs to support those targets.*

Site Improvement Investment Considerations

The findings of the Phase II study, along with an estimate of the ROM costs needed to make functional site and infrastructure improvements, provides concrete data for Economic Development Offices (EDOs) to consider while making investment decisions to improve site marketability. There may be strong business cases for increasing site competitiveness by making incremental investment in infrastructure improvements or mitigation of development challenges. There are many conditions to be considered in investing significant dollars on speculative site improvements including market, economic, fiscal, real estate, and political factors. While the information provided through the SSI Phase II study should not be exclusively considered for site improvement expenditures, the findings may provide an initial quasi prospectus on site development expenditure and associated return-on-investment (ROI).

Site Marketing

The best greenfield site in America is of no consequence to the host community if industry prospects are unaware of its value and availability. Many EDOs invest in branding and marketing campaigns to showcase their community's differentiating attributes to attract business investment. If prematurely launched, many communities unfortunately become "the dog that caught the car". The well-qualified community successfully attracts the serious interest of a prospective company only to lose the project, and possibly credibility for future projects, because it fails to offer a competitive site.

It is the opinion of LL+D, based on extensive industrial and commercial site selection experience, that the methodology, objectivity, and level of detail and completeness provided in this report are sufficient to support the competitive claims of the subject site for its intended project land use(s). Accordingly, the information contained in this report can and should be used to supplement site marketing materials, specifically for RFI responses and proactive target industry solicitations. However, EDOs should exercise judicious use of SSI Phase II site information for the purposes of site marketing in advance of formal landowner engagement and security of real estate purchase opinion. The real estate purchase option is pursued during SSI Phase III: Landowner Engagement.

Warranty

All Phase II project tasks are intended to serve as an informed guide to determination of site advancement to the formal due diligence phase of inventory development. All information and opinions provided in this report are limited to planning-level engineering and environmental considerations and do not rise to the investigative level of study for site design uses.

All data used in this study originates from public domain sources. All findings derived from the use of public domain data are subject to potential errors and omissions inherent digital data sets which may include spatial and attribute accuracy, completeness, and currency. Data and other information cited in this study has not been verified for quality of accuracy. As such, the confidence in findings provided herein and corresponding opinions are subject to the limitations of the data and other information sources consulted in the conduct of this study.

Ultimate site development potential and fatal flaw analysis cannot be determined without physically visiting the site and conducting formal engineering and environmental due diligence. However, Leotta Location and Design is confident that our site screening methodology is highly effective in eliminating low quality or practically undevelopable sites and presents candidate sites with a high likelihood of confirming results through more formal engineering and environmental due diligence.

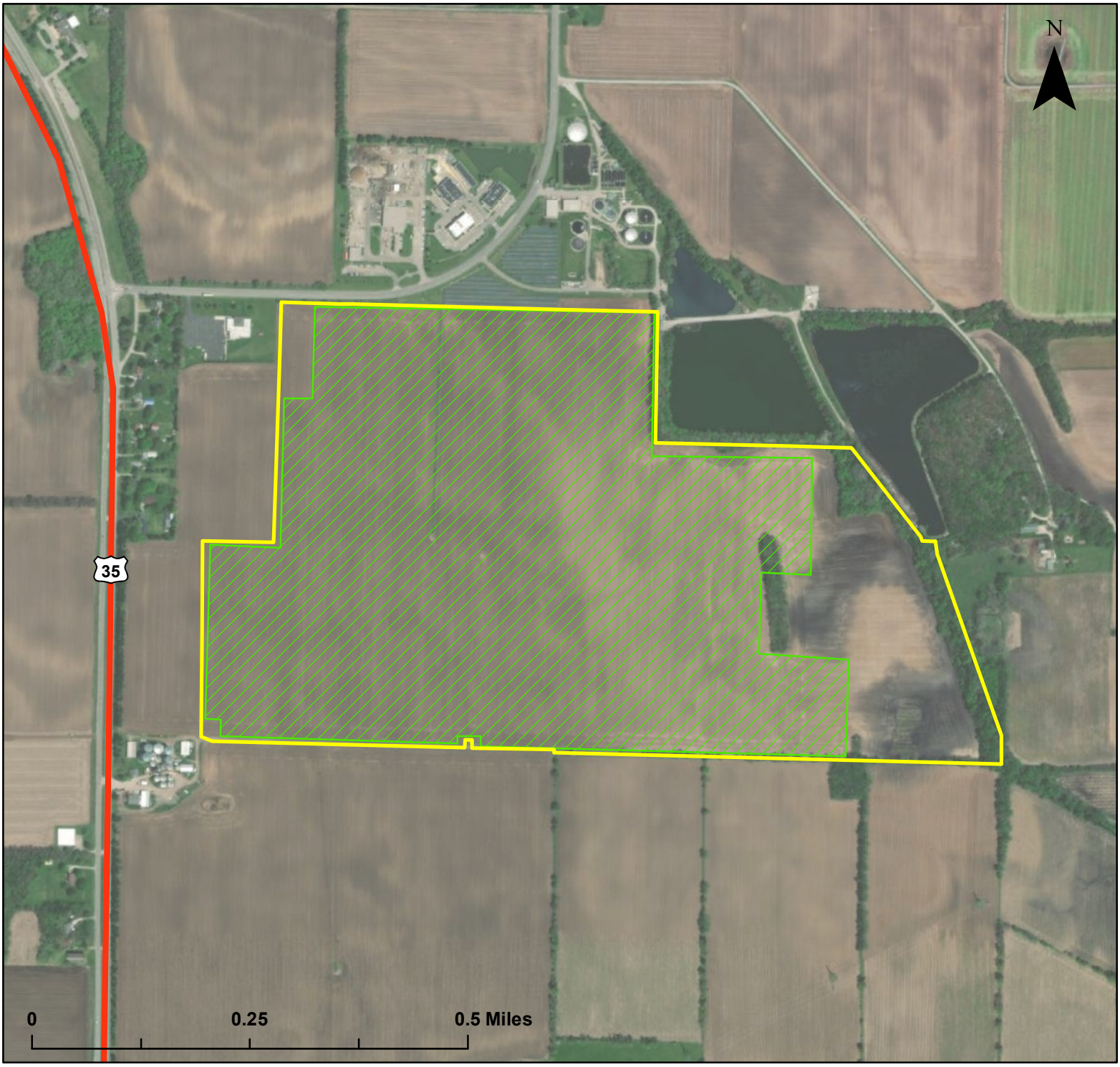
APPENDIX A

SITE MAPS

SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010 (235.5 acres)



SITE MAP

Site: ~235.5 acres

Buildable Area: ~184.3 acres

Legend

- U.S. Highway
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

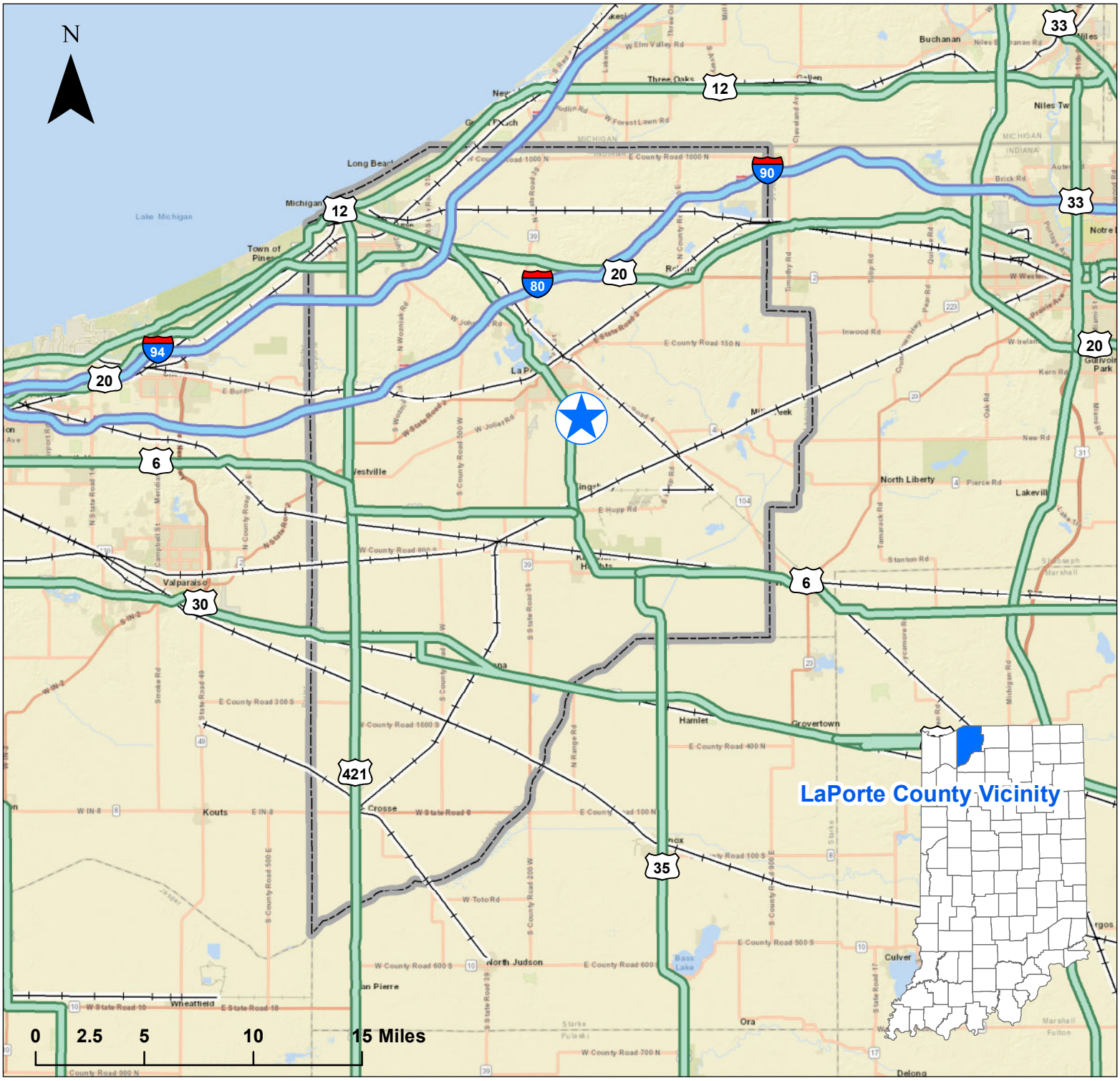
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010 (235.5 acres)



Legend

- Site Point
- Interstate
- U.S. Highway
- Class I Railroad
- LaPorte County

SITE VICINITY

LaPorte County, Indiana

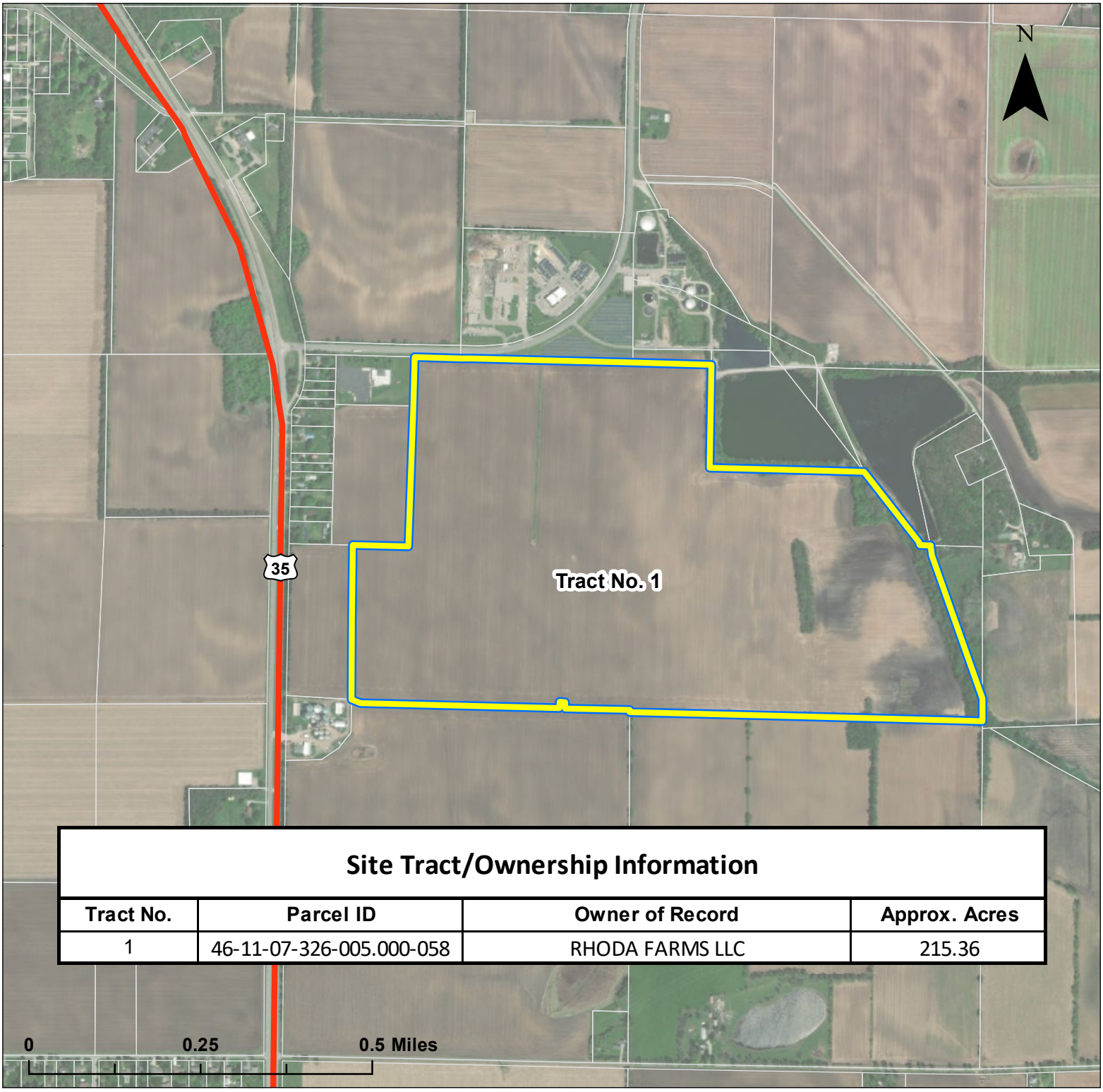
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LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010 (235.5 acres)



Site Tract/Ownership Information

Tract No.	Parcel ID	Owner of Record	Approx. Acres
1	46-11-07-326-005.000-058	RHODA FARMS LLC	215.36

Legend

- U.S. Highway
- Site Boundary
- Site Parcel
- Parcel

SITE PARCEL CONFIGURATION

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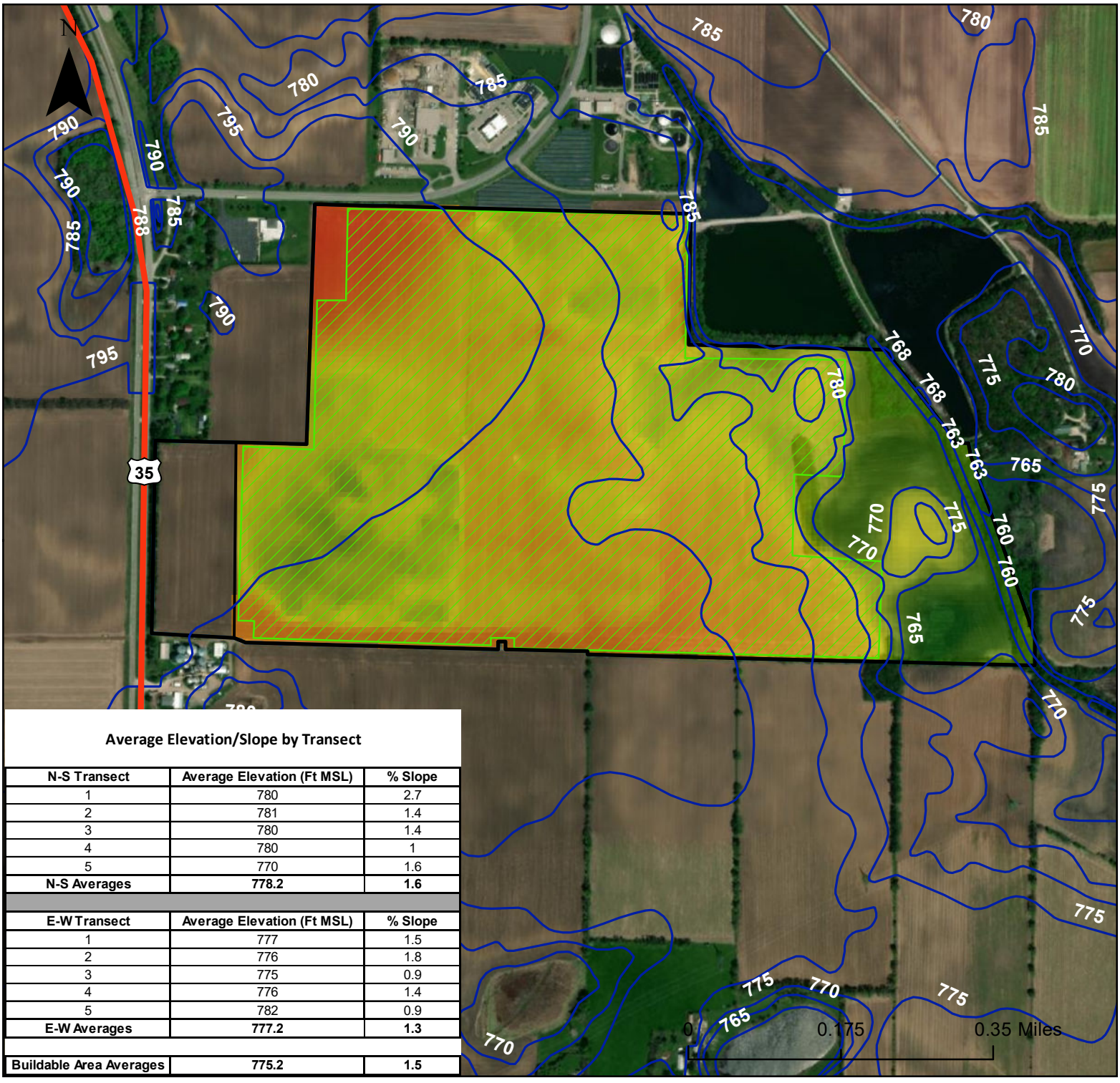
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LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010 (235.5 acres)

LEAP
La Porte Economic Advancement PARTNERSHIP



Average Elevation/Slope by Transect

N-S Transect	Average Elevation (Ft MSL)	% Slope
1	780	2.7
2	781	1.4
3	780	1.4
4	780	1
5	770	1.6
N-S Averages	**778.2**	**1.6**

E-W Transect	Average Elevation (Ft MSL)	% Slope
1	777	1.5
2	776	1.8
3	775	0.9
4	776	1.4
5	782	0.9
E-W Averages	**777.2**	**1.3**
Buildable Area Averages	**775.2**	**1.5**

Legend

- Interstate
- State Highway
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area
- Contours - 10 ft
- **LiDAR-derived DEM**
  - High : 795.2
  - Low : 758.6

BUILDABLE AREA ELEVATION/SLOPE

LiDAR-derived Digital Elevation Model

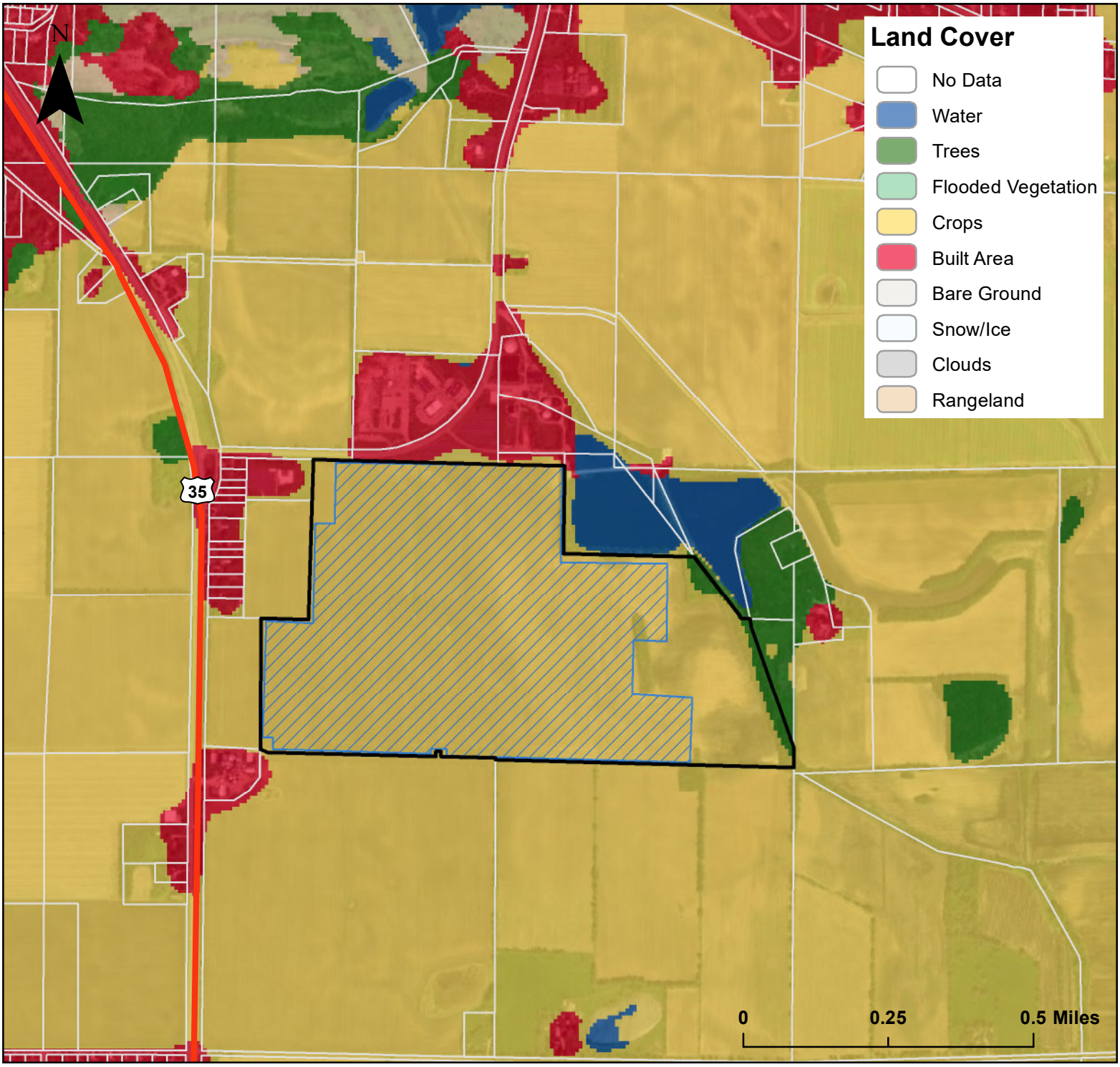
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LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010 (235.5 acres)



LAND COVER CLASSIFICATIONS

Indiana 2017-2021 Land Cover Map

Legend

- U.S. Highway
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area
- Parcel

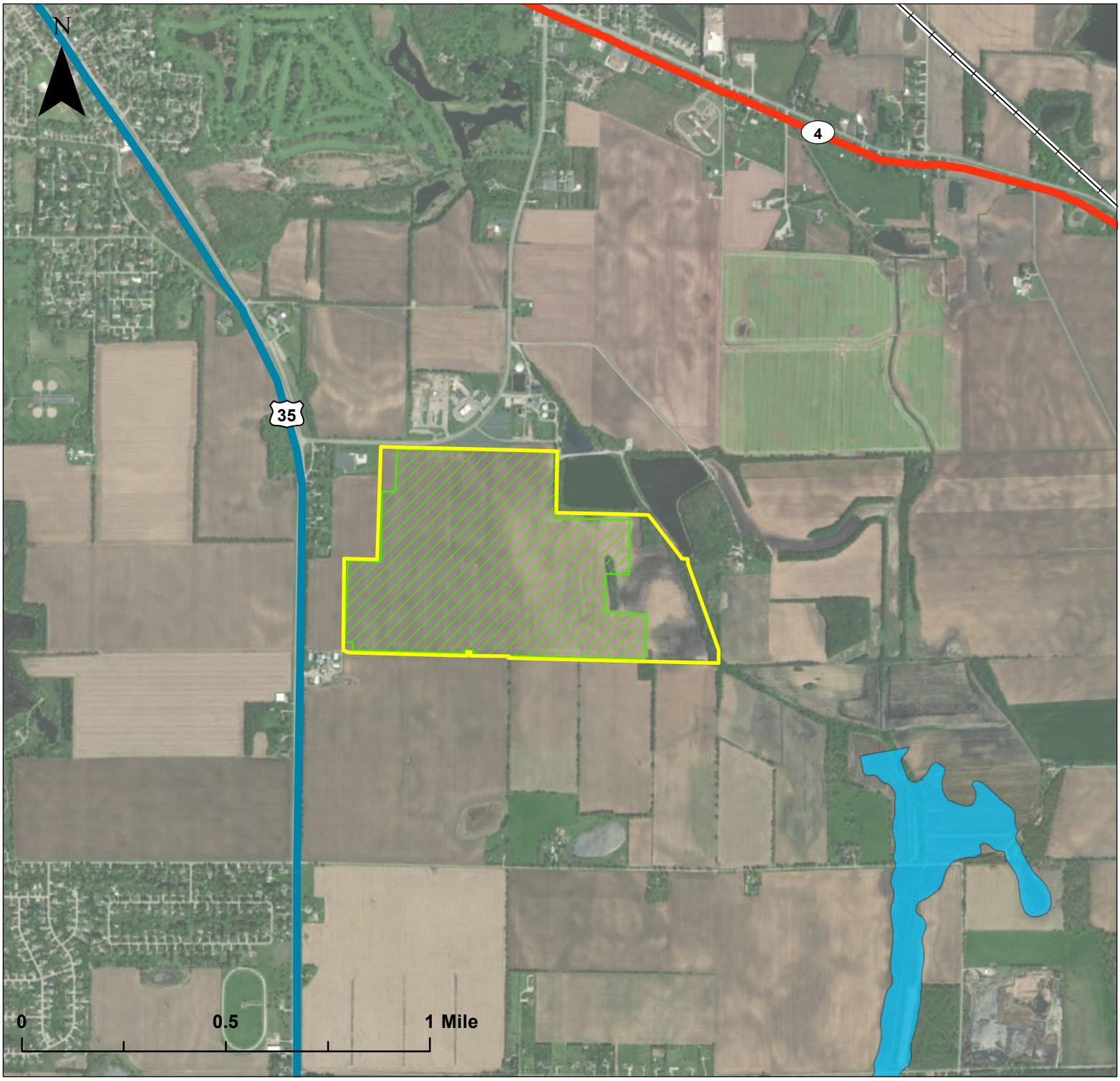
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010 (243.6 acres)



Legend

- U.S. Highway
- State Highway
- Rail
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

Flood Zone

- A
- X

Potential Flood Hazard

FEMA National Flood Hazard Layer

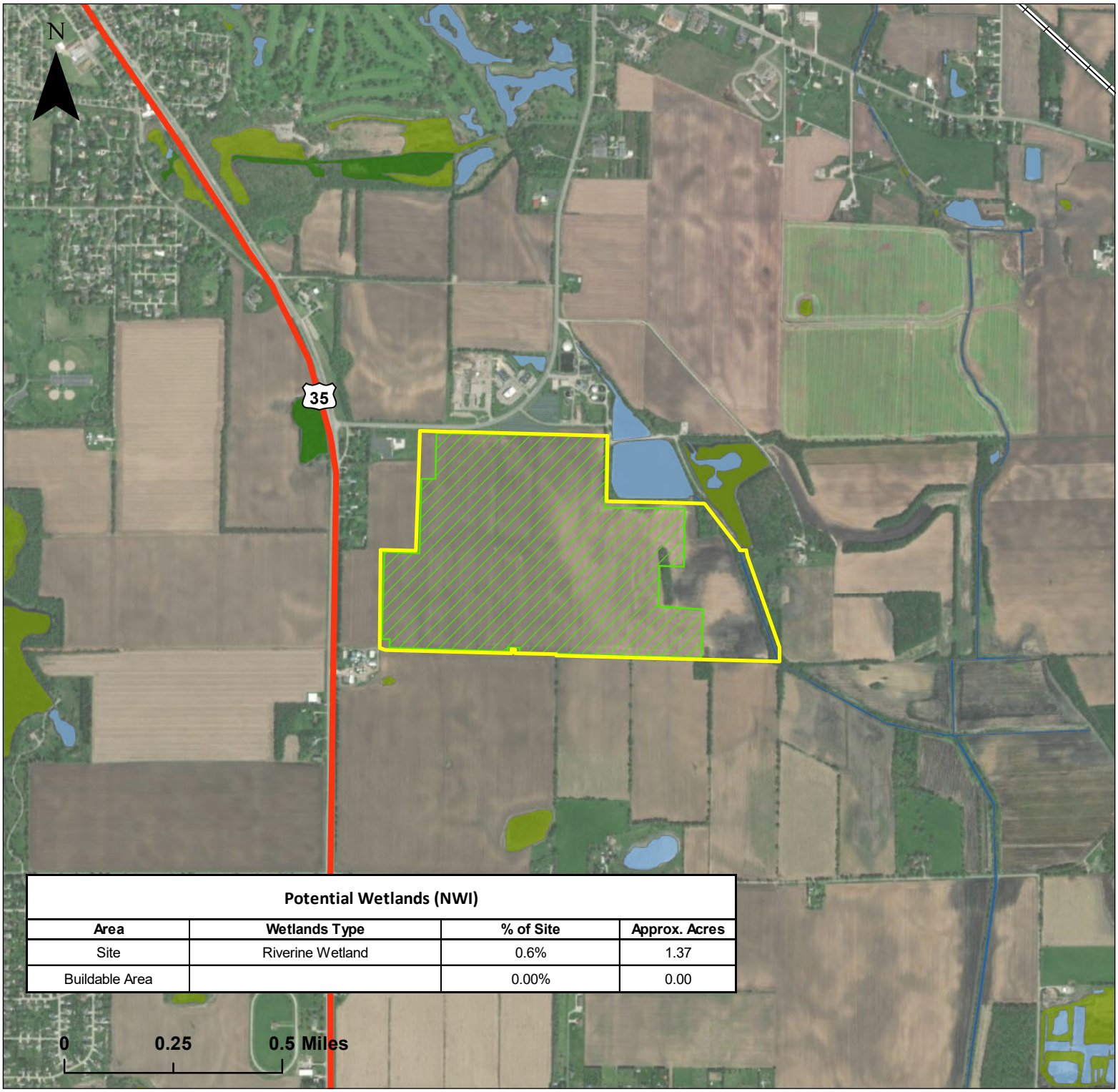
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LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010 (235.5 acres)



Potential Wetlands (NWI)			
Area	**Wetlands Type**	**% of Site**	**Approx. Acres**
Site	Riverine Wetland	0.6%	1.37
Buildable Area		0.00%	0.00

Legend

- Rail
- U.S. Highway
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

National Wetlands Inventory

Potential Wetland Type

- Freshwater Emergent Wetland
- Freshwater Forested/Shrub Wetland
- Freshwater Pond
- Riverine

Potential Wetlands

USFW/USGS National Wetlands Inventory

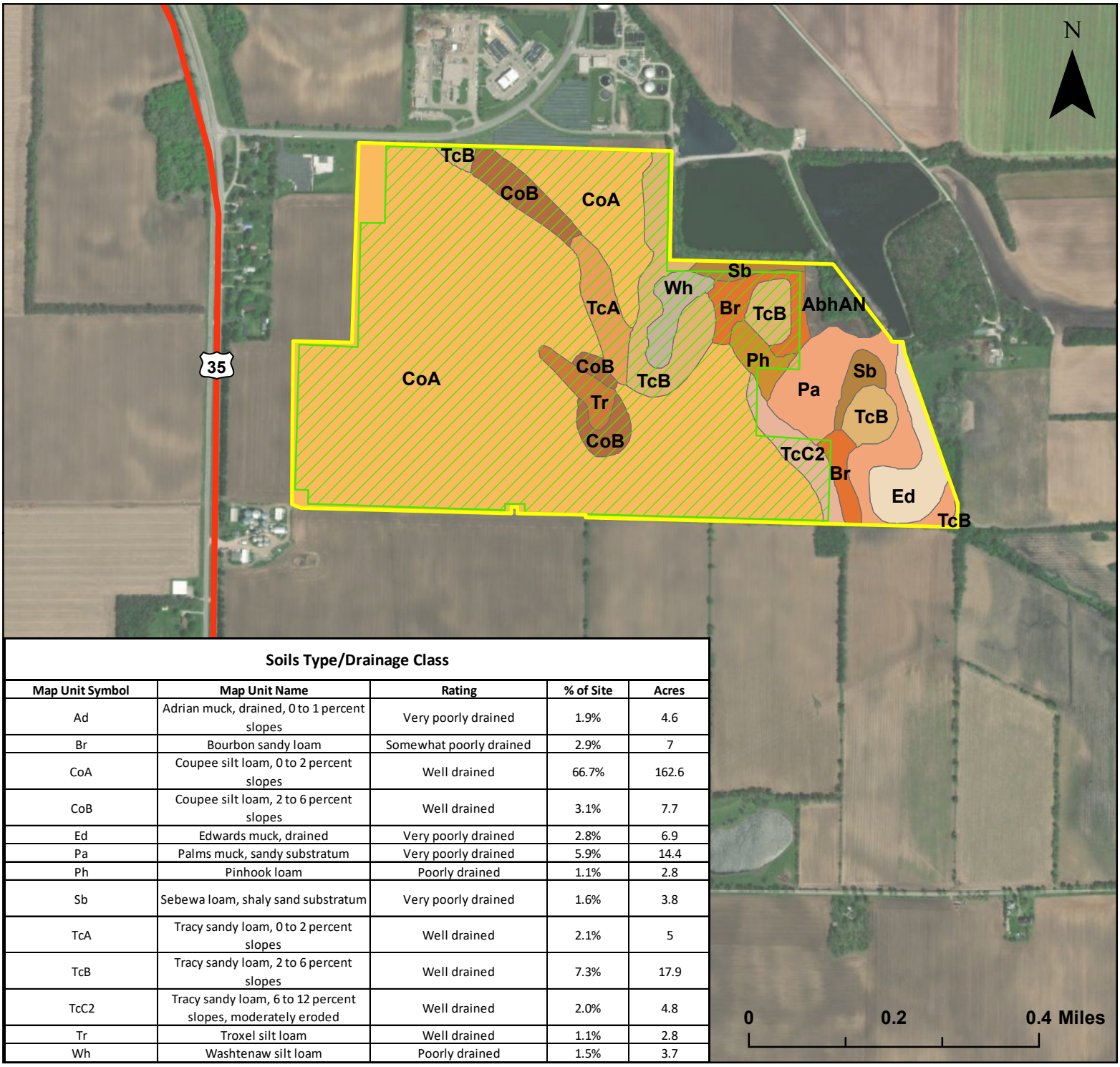
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LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010 (235.5 acres)



Soils Type/Drainage Class

Map Unit Symbol	Map Unit Name	Rating	% of Site	Acres
Ad	Adrian muck, drained, 0 to 1 percent slopes	Very poorly drained	1.9%	4.6
Br	Bourbon sandy loam	Somewhat poorly drained	2.9%	7
CoA	Coupee silt loam, 0 to 2 percent slopes	Well drained	66.7%	162.6
CoB	Coupee silt loam, 2 to 6 percent slopes	Well drained	3.1%	7.7
Ed	Edwards muck, drained	Very poorly drained	2.8%	6.9
Pa	Palms muck, sandy substratum	Very poorly drained	5.9%	14.4
Ph	Pinhook loam	Poorly drained	1.1%	2.8
Sb	Sebewa loam, shaly sand substratum	Very poorly drained	1.6%	3.8
TcA	Tracy sandy loam, 0 to 2 percent slopes	Well drained	2.1%	5
TcB	Tracy sandy loam, 2 to 6 percent slopes	Well drained	7.3%	17.9
TcC2	Tracy sandy loam, 6 to 12 percent slopes, moderately eroded	Well drained	2.0%	4.8
Tr	Troxel silt loam	Well drained	1.1%	2.8
Wh	Washtenaw silt loam	Poorly drained	1.5%	3.7

Legend

- U.S. Highway
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

Soil Type

- Ad
- Br
- CoA
- CoB
- Ed
- Pa
- Ph
- Sb
- TcA
- TcB
- TcC2
- Tr
- Wh

SSURGO SOILS

Map Unit Name, Percent Slopes

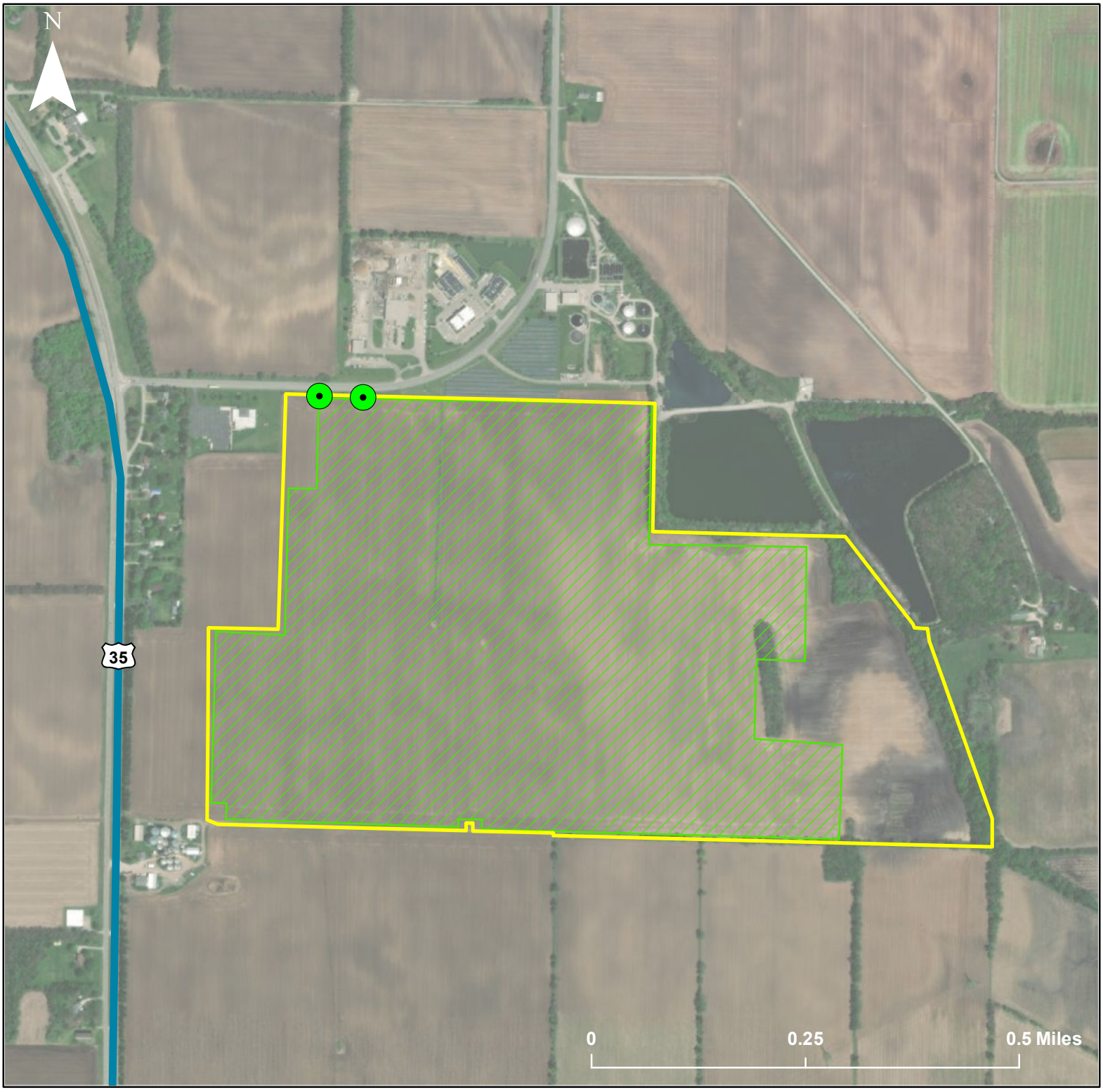
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LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010 (235.5 acres)



Legend

- Potential Egress/Ingress Point
- U.S. Highway
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

SITE TRANSPORTATION FEATURES

with Potential Site Access Points

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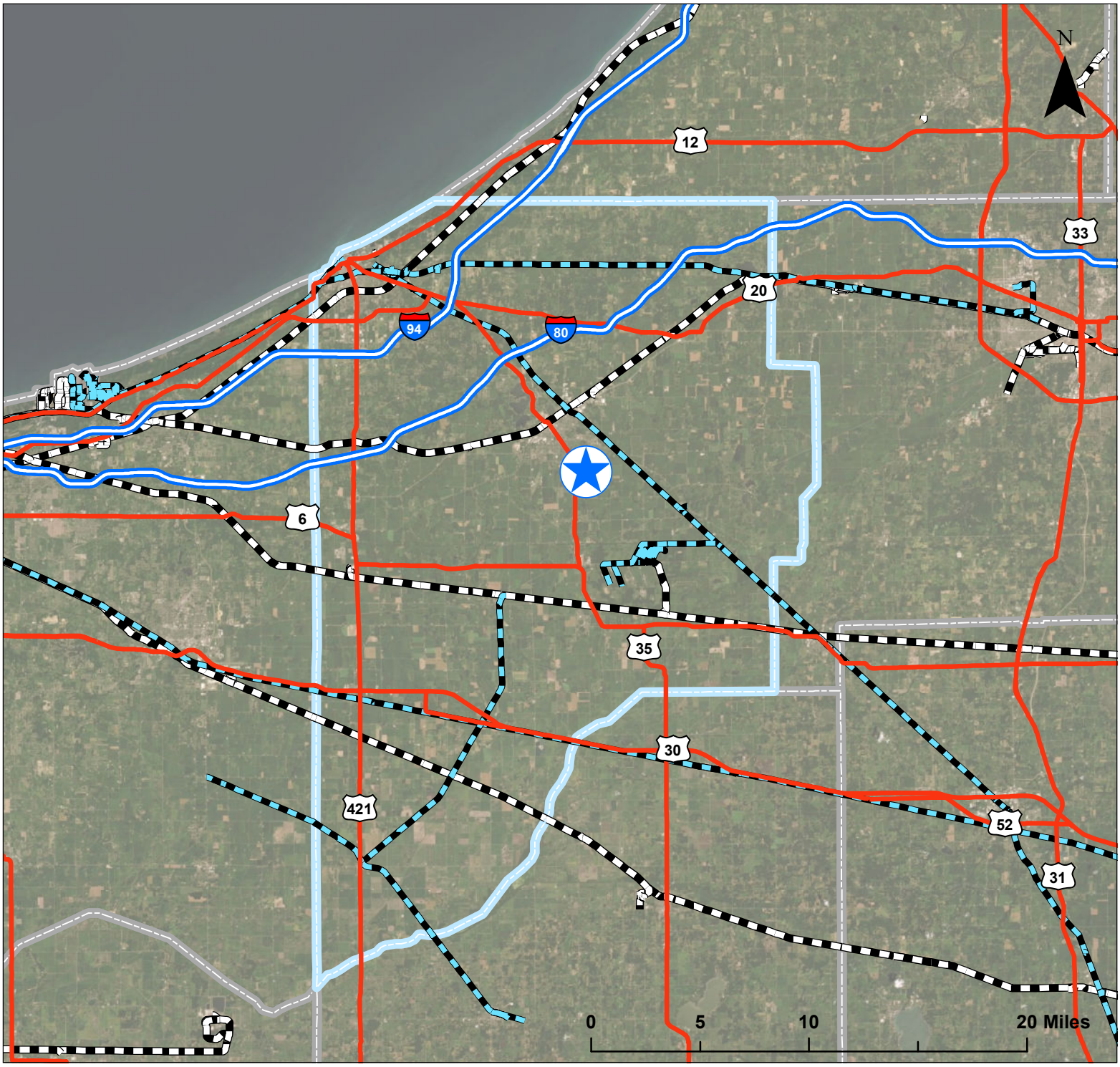
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LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010 (235.5 acres)

LEAP
La Porte Economic Advancement PARTNERSHIP



SITE PRIMARY TRANSPORTATION ASSETS

Legend

- Class I Railroad
- Shortline
- Interstate
- U.S. Highway
- Site Point
- LaPorte County
- County

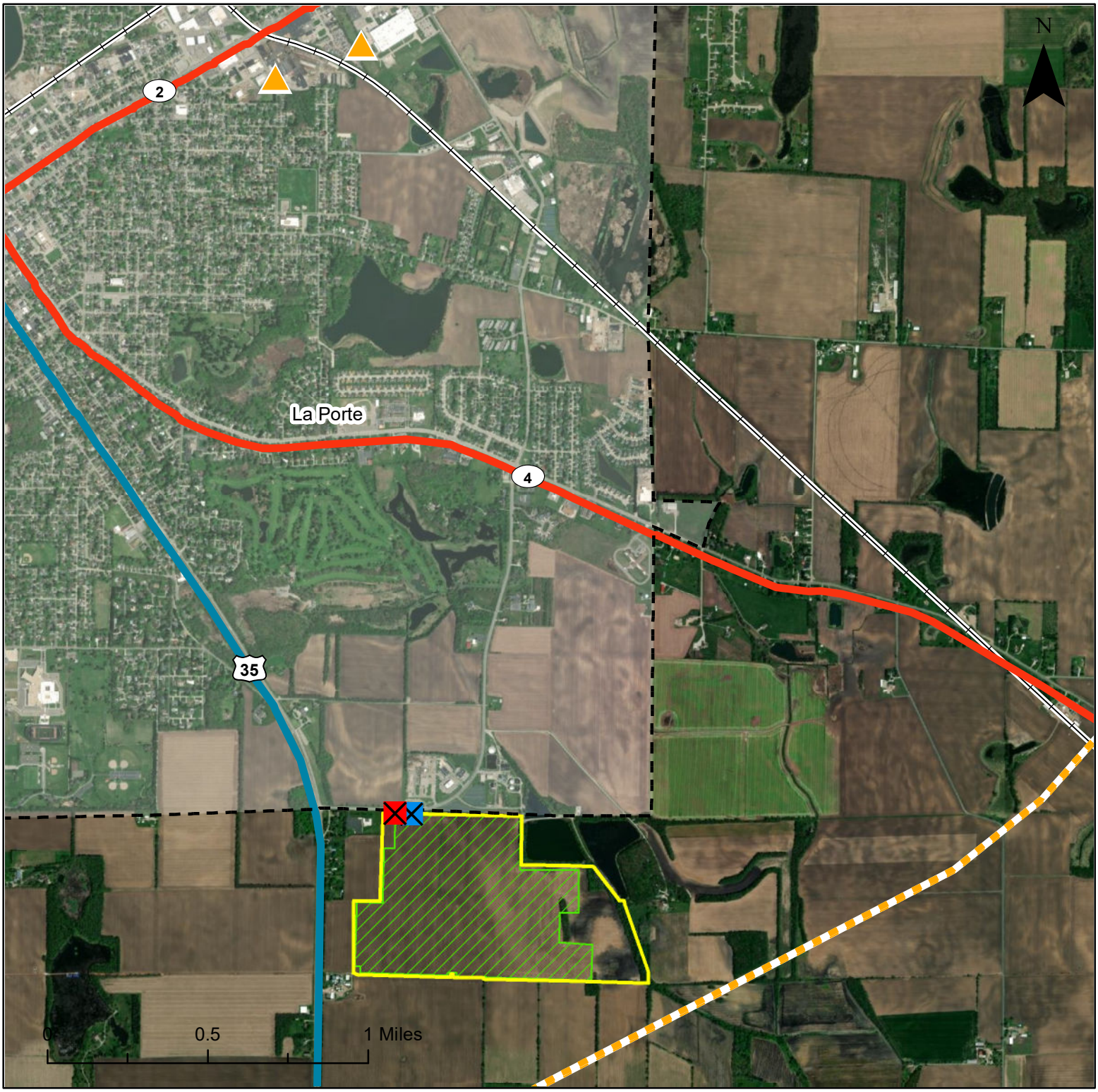
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010 (235.5 acres)



Legend

Utility Type

- Electric, Gas
- Water, Sewer
- Electric Substation
- Electric Transmission Line
- U.S. Highway
- State Highway
- Interstate
- Rail
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area
- Municipal Limits

ENERGY INFRASTRUCTURE/UTILITY ACCESS

with Utility Access Point

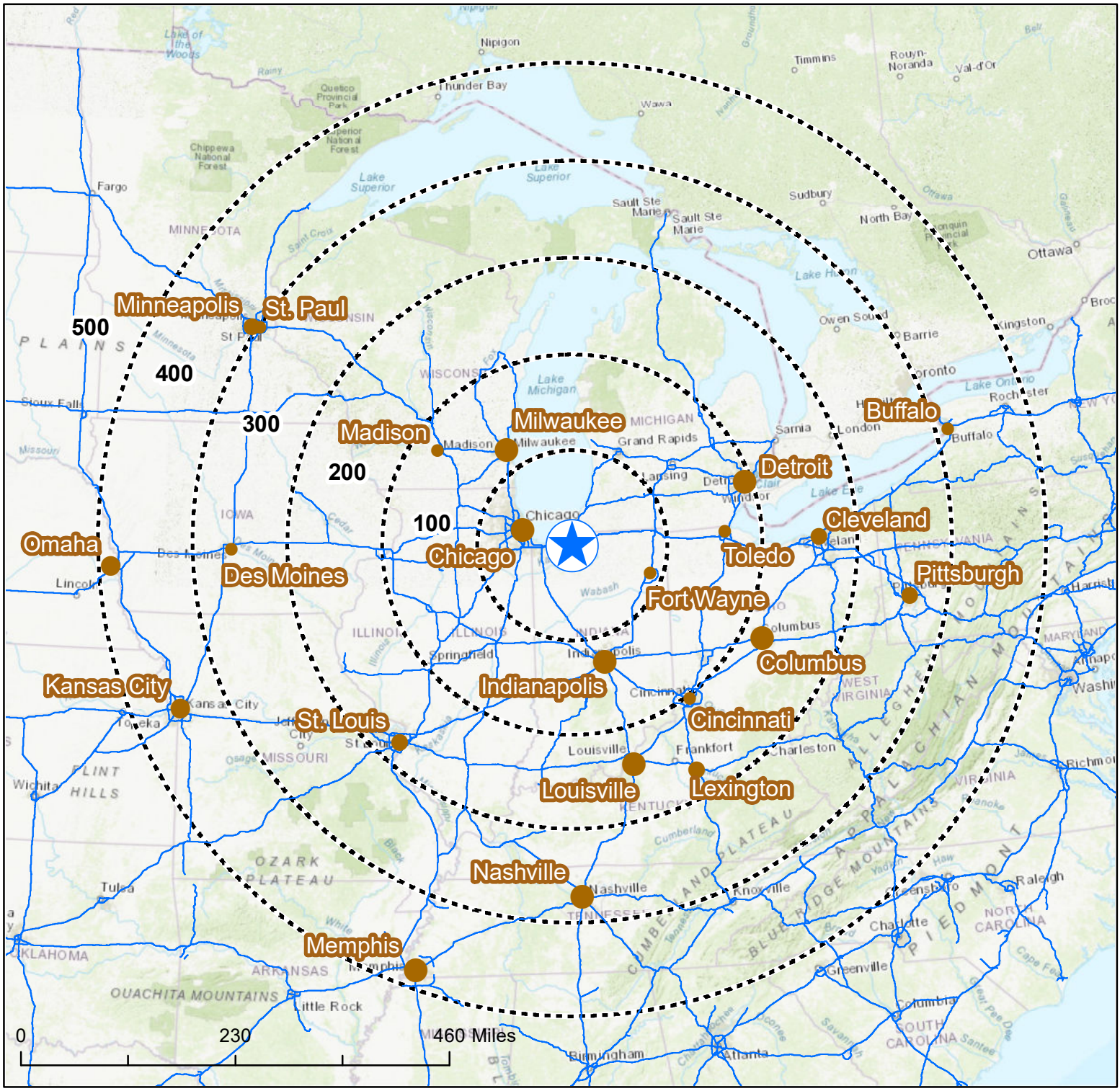
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010 (235.5 acres)



Legend

- Site Point
- Interstate
- Distance in Miles

Major Markets

Population

- <100,000
- 100,000 - 199,999
- 200,000 - 299,999
- 300,000 - 399,999
- 400,000 - 499,999
- >500,000

TRAVEL DISTANCE

Major Markets

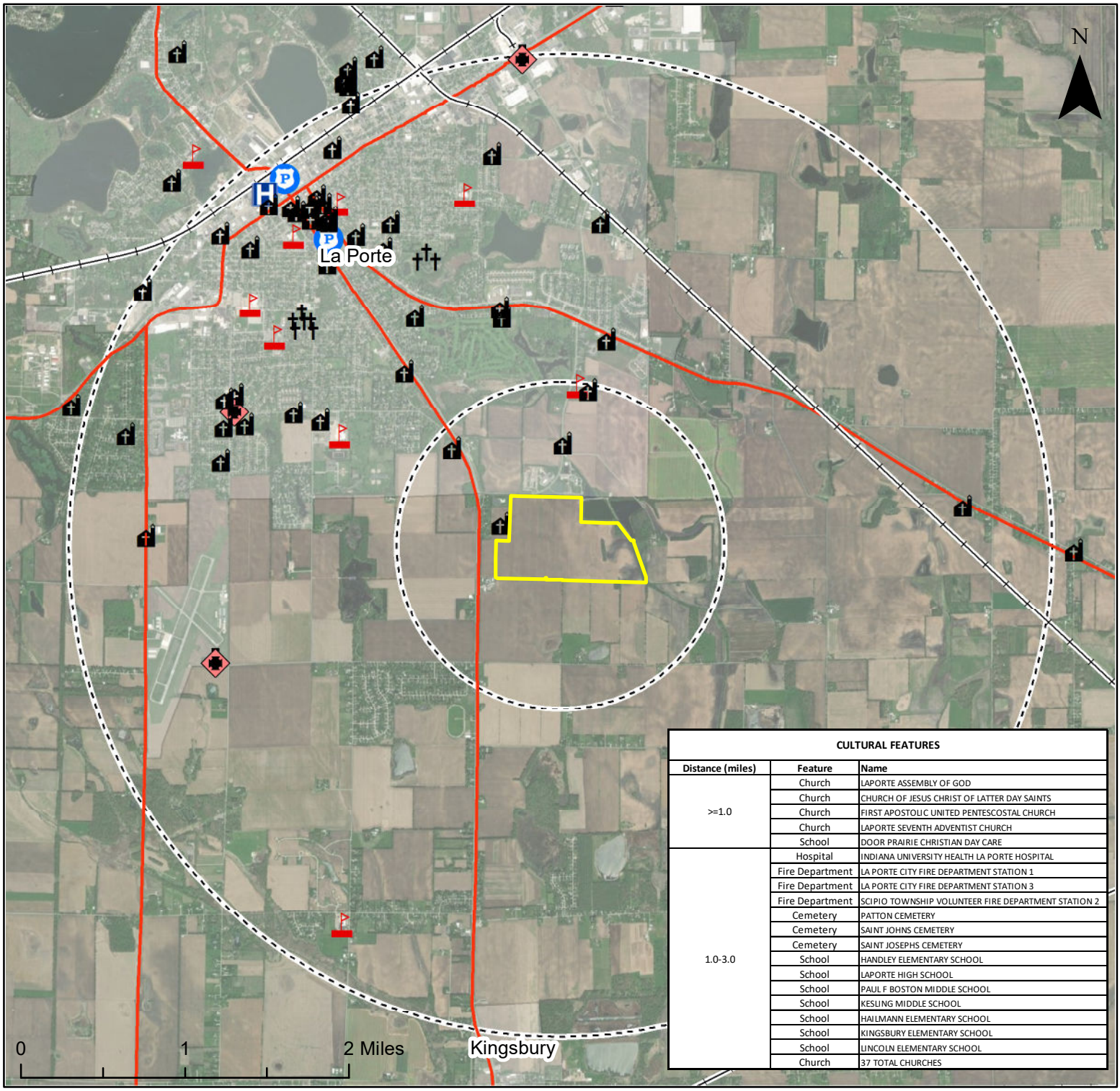
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LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010 (235.5 acres)



CULTURAL FEATURES

Distance (miles)	Feature	Name
>=1.0	Church	LAPORTE ASSEMBLY OF GOD
	Church	CHURCH OF JESUS CHRIST OF LATTER DAY SAINTS
	Church	FIRST APOSTOLIC UNITED PENTESCOSTAL CHURCH
	Church	LAPORTE SEVENTH ADVENTIST CHURCH
	School	DOOR PRAIRIE CHRISTIAN DAY CARE
1.0-3.0	Hospital	INDIANA UNIVERSITY HEALTH LA PORTE HOSPITAL
	Fire Department	LA PORTE CITY FIRE DEPARTMENT STATION 1
	Fire Department	LA PORTE CITY FIRE DEPARTMENT STATION 3
	Fire Department	SCIPIO TOWNSHIP VOLUNTEER FIRE DEPARTMENT STATION 2
	Cemetery	PATTON CEMETERY
	Cemetery	SAINT JOHNS CEMETERY
	Cemetery	SAINT JOSEPHS CEMETERY
	School	HANDLEY ELEMENTARY SCHOOL
	School	LAPORTE HIGH SCHOOL
	School	PAUL F BOSTON MIDDLE SCHOOL
	School	KESLING MIDDLE SCHOOL
	School	HAILMANN ELEMENTARY SCHOOL
	School	KINGSBURY ELEMENTARY SCHOOL
	School	LINCOLN ELEMENTARY SCHOOL
	Church	37 TOTAL CHURCHES

Legend

- Rail
- Highway
- Site Boundary
- Distance in miles
- Municipal Limits
- Police Station
- Fire Rescue/EMS
- Hospital
- School
- Cemetery
- Church

CULTURAL FEATURES

within 1.0 and 3.0 Miles of Site

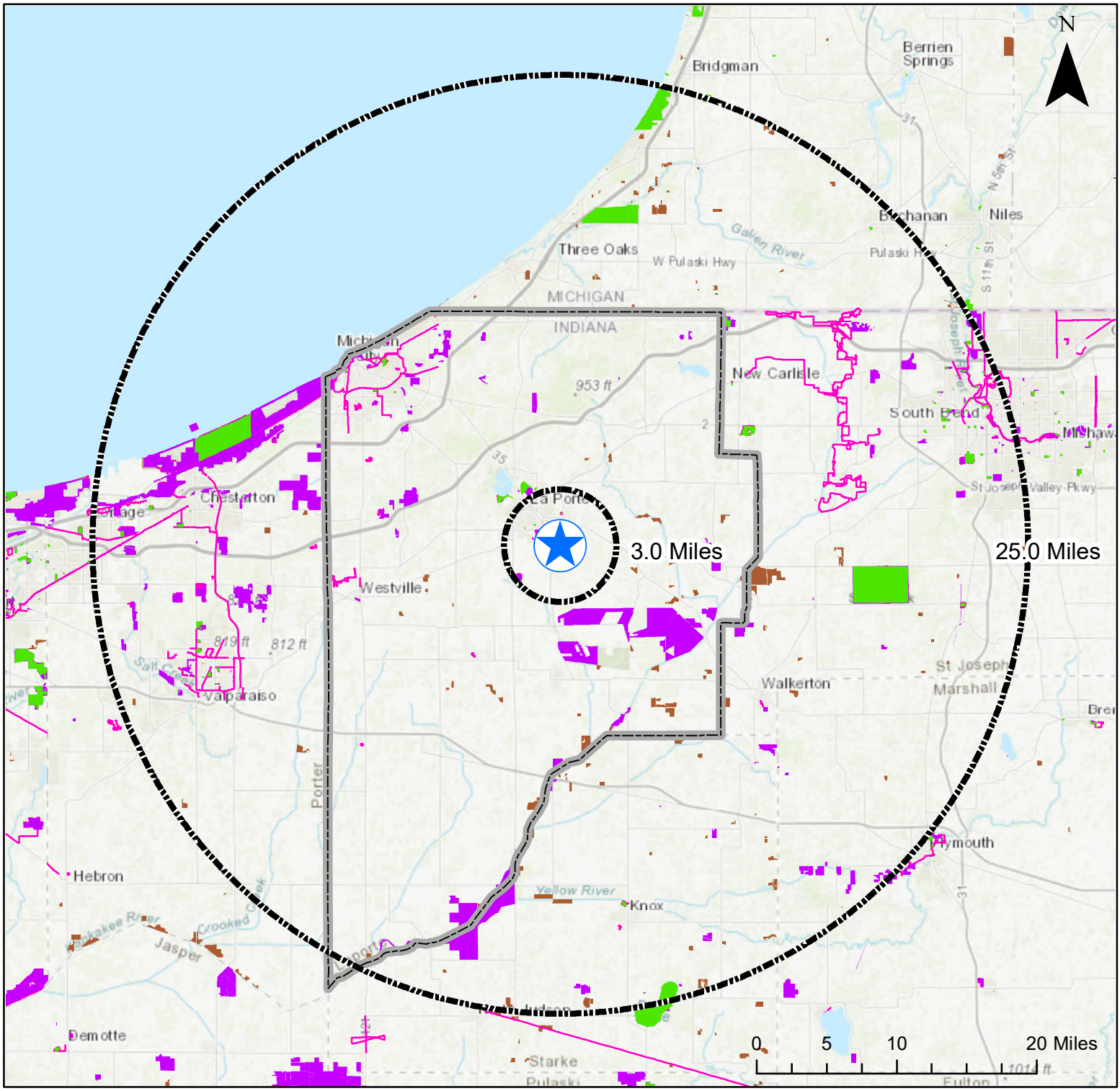
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010 (235.5 acres)



Legend

- Site Point
- IDNR Trails
- LaPorte County
- Local/State Parks
- National Forests
- INDR Managed Lands
- Conservation Easements
- Distance in Miles

FEDERAL, STATE, AND LOCAL PARKS AND PROTECTED AREAS

within 3.0 and 25.0 Miles of Site

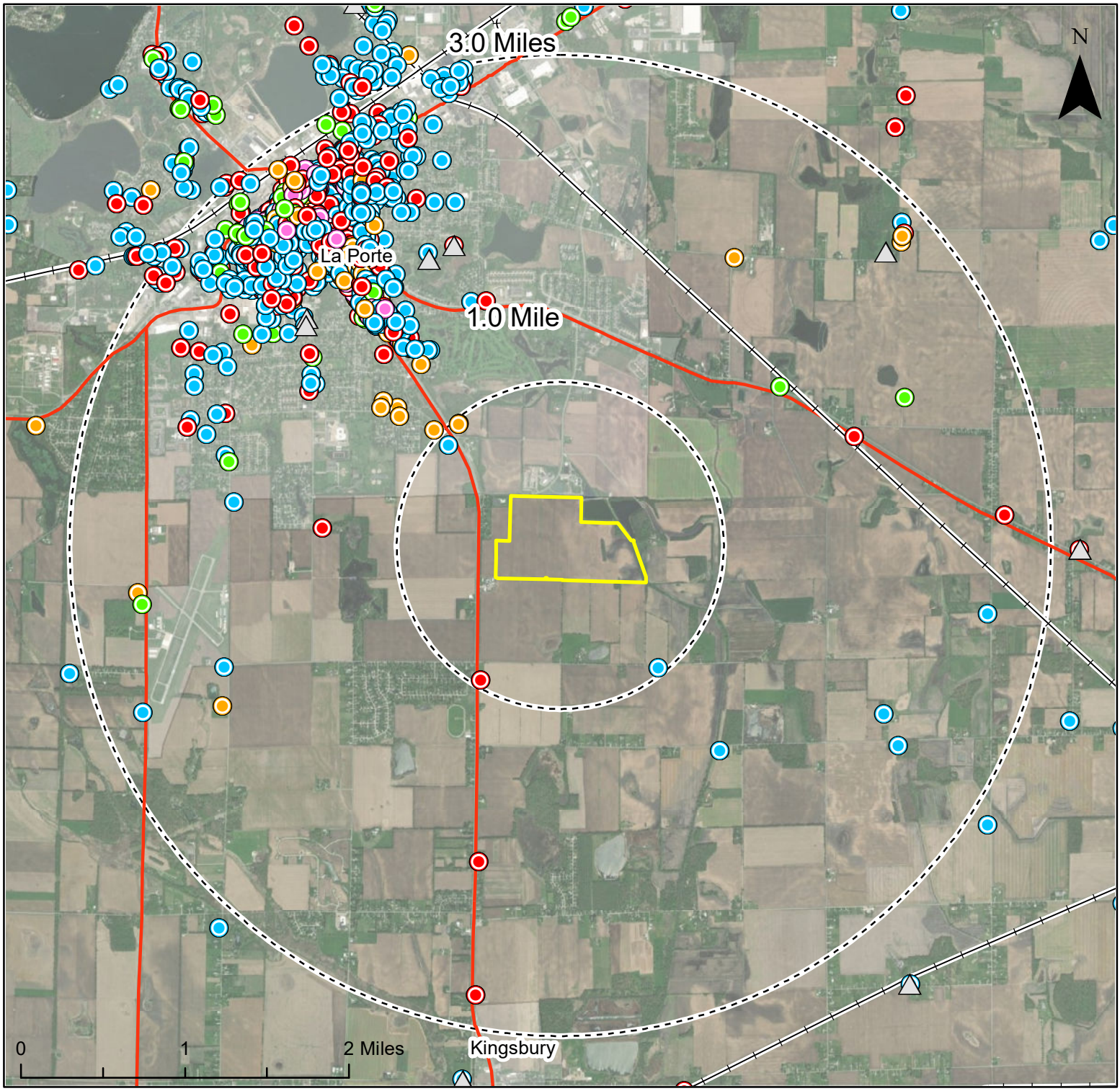
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LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-010 (243.6 acres)



Historic Sites and Structures

- Demolished
- Non-Contributing
- Contributing
- Notable
- Outstanding

- Historic Bridge
- Cemetery
- Limited Access
- Rail
- Highway
- Site Boundary
- Distance in miles

HISTORIC RESOURCES

within 1.0 and 3.0 Miles of Site

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